

FieldCommand Incident Management System

Open-Source · Offline-First · Field-Deployable

FIELDCOMMAND

Incident Management System v1.0

INSTALLATION GUIDE

ASUS RT-BE58 Go · UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE · Raspberry Pi 5 · Pironman MAX 5

ICS/NIMS All-Hazards · Amateur Radio EMCOMM · August 08, 2026

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1. Overview & What's Included

FieldCommand is a complete off-grid emergency communications and ICS management system built on two Raspberry Pi 5 units — one running all 49 web-based tools covering ICS forms, net logging, resource tracking, FEMA cost documentation, APRS, Winlink, and personnel accountability; one dedicated to the AMPRNet / 44Net gateway. WAN connectivity is optional and configurable — your group chooses the primary source (cellular modem, satellite dish, site Ethernet, or tethered phone) and whether to add a secondary source for automatic failover, all managed by the ASUS RT-BE58 Go Wi-Fi 7 router. Two additional ASUS RT-BE58 Go routers extend EMCOMM-NET as AiMesh nodes for large venues. Any phone, tablet, or laptop connects to EMCOMM-NET and reaches all tools at <http://192.168.50.1> — no internet, no app, no per-device setup required. When WAN is available, NWS alerts, APRS-IS, and HF propagation data activate automatically.

SAR Network Operations: The Starcom Net Logger includes a dedicated SAR Net mode (Search & Rescue) accessible directly from the Starcom / Public Safety dashboard. It provides a SAR-specific check-in log with unit type tracking, zone assignments, and resource status. The Starcom Resource Map provides the tactical overlay for SAR unit positions. These features are integrated into the main FieldCommand platform — no separate module is required.

COMPONENT	DESCRIPTION	COMPONENT	DESCRIPTION
30 Web Pages	Full dashboard, net logs, ICS forms, maps, roster, cheat sheets	Dead Man's Switch	Per-net inactivity monitor with warning and trigger states
Net Control Logger	Amateur + Starcom nets, FCC autofill, ICS-309 export	Pre-Flight Checklist	GO/CAUTION/NO-GO deployment readiness check
ICS Platform	Command, Operations, Planning, Logistics, Finance sections	HF Propagation	Solar indices, band conditions, A/K-index
APRS Tactical Map	Direwolf + YAAC merged, offline tiles, overlays	Repeater Database	RepeaterBook CSV, filter by band, mode, ARES affiliation
Member Roster	your organization directory with certs, equipment, activations	Reference Library	Upload and serve field reference docs across EMCOMM-NET
NTS Radiogram	ARRL-formatted radiogram generator with traffic log	Kiwix Library	WikiMed, Wikipedia, iFixit — offline at port 8081
ICS-213/214/309	Fillable ICS forms with print output and incident archiving	FCC Callsign Lookup	~800K licensees — instant offline search
Winlink Form Import	Import Winlink Express XML forms to incident archive	Pat Winlink	Browser-based backup Winlink client at port 8090
JS8Call Integration	Dashboard card opens JS8Call web API on Windows laptop	ICS Planning P	Interactive 15-phase planning cycle guide

1. Hardware Requirements

Supported Hardware — Raspberry Pi Servers

FieldCommand v1.0 uses two Raspberry Pi 5 units: one as the FieldCommand application server and one as the dedicated AMPRNet / 44Net gateway. Keeping them separate means the gateway can be rebooted, reconfigured, or upgraded without affecting the FieldCommand server, net logs, or active incidents.

UNIT	HARDWARE	STORAGE	ROLE
FieldCommand Server	Raspberry Pi 5 — 16 GB RAM / Pironman MAX 5 tower enclosure (dual M.2 NVMe, OLED, active cooling)	2× 1 TB NVMe SSD / configured as RAID 1	Runs all FieldCommand services: web server, FCC database, net logging, ICS platform, APRS, Kiwix, Winlink, maps, and health monitor. Static IP: 192.168.50.1
44Net Gateway	Raspberry Pi 5 — 16 GB RAM / Argon NEO 5 M.2 BRED case (compact, passive-cooled, M.2 SATA slot) / Pi OS Desktop (64-bit)	256 GB M.2 SATA SSD (OS + WireGuard + routing + status service)	Dedicated AMPRNet / 44Net gateway. Runs WireGuard tunnel to amprgw.ampr.org, ip routing between EMCOMM-NET and 44.0.0.0/8, and a status page at 192.168.50.2. Completely independent from the FieldCommand server.

Network Hardware

Wi-Fi is provided by the ASUS RT-BE58 Go travel router — neither Pi runs a Wi-Fi hotspot. The UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE provides 16 wired gigabit ports for both Pi servers, the Windows laptop, four operator workstations, a network printer, and room for expansion.

DEVICE	ROLE	NOTES
ASUS RT-BE58 Go	Wi-Fi 7 access point / DHCP server / WAN gateway	Dual-band Wi-Fi 7 (802.11be). 2.5G LAN uplink to switch. USB-C 18W power. Handles EMCOMM-NET Wi-Fi, DHCP for 192.168.50.100-200, and optional WAN routing.
UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE	16-port gigabit managed switch / 8x PoE + 8x non-PoE / 2x 1G SFP uplink	Port layout: 1=ASUS router uplink, 2=FieldCommand Pi, 3=44Net Gateway Pi, 4=Windows laptop, 5=color MFP printer, 6-9=Pi 500 workstations, 10=Satellite dish (optional), 11-12=AiMesh nodes, 13-16=spare. ~\$200. PoE ports power cameras, future UniFi APs, or PoE devices without a separate injector.

Accessories & Cables

ITEM	REQUIRED?	PURPOSE
USB-A drive (32 GB+, labeled FIELDCOMMAND)	Recommended	Auto-backup trigger — insert to back up all runtime data instantly
External USB hard drive 1 TB+ (e.g. LaCie Rugged or LaCie Mobile Drive)	Recommended	Incident archive and full system backup. LaCie Rugged is shock/drop/crush resistant. Label FIELDCOMMAND for auto-backup compatibility.
USB GPS receiver (u-blox or GlobalSat)	Optional	Live position for tactical map and NWS alerts
Powered USB hub (4- or 7-port, with power supply)	Optional	Recommended if connecting GPS + backup drive + TNC simultaneously. Must be powered — unpowered hubs can cause instability.
USB Printer (e.g. Brother HL-L2350DW, HP LaserJet)	Optional	Shared across EMCOMM-NET via CUPS (installed automatically). Or connect a Wi-Fi printer directly to EMCOMM-NET.

Amateur Radio Accessories (amateur radio group only)

The items in this section are only needed if a licensed amateur radio group is involved in the deployment. If FieldCommand is being deployed by a public safety agency or served organization without amateur radio operators, skip this section entirely.

ITEM	REQUIRED?	PURPOSE
USB TNC — Digirig Mobile	If using APRS	USB soundcard + serial CAT interface in one unit. Connects to any radio with a 3.5mm audio port. Enables APRS transmit/receive via Direwolf and YAAC. FieldCommand assigns stable /dev/tnc0 device name via udev rule.
USB TNC — Signalink USB (alternative to Digirig)	If using APRS	Tigertronics Signalink USB — USB audio interface, requires rig-specific audio cable. Widely used and well-supported. Same udev /dev/tnc0 assignment as Digirig.
Mobilinkd TNC4 (Bluetooth alternative)	If using APRS	Bluetooth APRS TNC — pairs with YAAC on the Pi or with a phone running APRSdroid. Useful when a USB port is not available or for portable deployments.
Rig interface cables	If using TNC	Radio-specific audio + PTT cable connecting the TNC to the transceiver. Digirig: cables available at digirig.net by radio model. Signalink: requires separate Tigertronics cable for each rig.
Windows laptop (Winlink Express + JS8Call)	If using HF	Any Windows 10/11 laptop with USB-A port and Wi-Fi. Required for Winlink Express, VARA HF, and JS8Call. Connects to the IC-7300 via USB-B cable. See Part 2E of this guide for setup.

USB Hub & Multi-Device Setup

The Pi 5 has four USB ports. A powered USB hub lets you connect GPS, TNC, backup drive, and other peripherals simultaneously. FieldCommand uses udev rules to assign stable device names regardless of hub port or plug order. The TNC entries in the table below apply only to amateur radio group deployments — if no TNC is used, the GPS and backup drive rows still apply.

DEVICE	STABLE NAME	HOW ASSIGNED	SERVICE
USB GPS receiver	/dev/gps0	udev rule matches by USB vendor/product ID	gpsd → tactical map
Digirig Mobile TNC	/dev/tnc0 /dev/digirig	udev rule matches by vendor ID + product string "Digirig Mobile". Distinguished from GPS even though both use CP2102 chip.	YAAC / Direwolf APRS
Signalink USB TNC	/dev/tnc0 /dev/signalink	udev rule matches by Texas Instruments PCM2904 chip. No conflict with GPS.	YAAC / Direwolf APRS
LaCie / USB backup drive (labeled FIELDCOMMAND)	/dev/sdX (auto-mounted)	udev backup rule triggers on label FIELDCOMMAND. Drive letter assigned dynamically.	fieldcommand-backup@.service

Both the Digirig Mobile TNC and GlobalSat BU-353-S4 GPS use the same USB chip (Silicon Labs CP2102, vendor 10c4:ea60). FieldCommand distinguishes them by USB product description string. The GPS rule excludes Digirig; the TNC rule requires the Digirig product string. Verify with: `udevadm info -a -n /dev/ttyUSB0 | grep -E "idVendor|idProduct|product"`

```
# List all USB serial devices
ls -la /dev/ttyUSB* /dev/ttyACM* 2>/dev/null

# Check the stable symlinks
ls -la /dev/gps0 /dev/tnc0 2>/dev/null

# Confirm GPS is outputting NMEA sentences
sudo cat /dev/gps0

# Use /dev/tnc0 in YAAC → Configure → Ports → Serial TNC
```

Complete Bill of Materials

ITEM	MODEL / SPEC	WHERE TO BUY
— FieldCommand Server (Pi 5 — 16 GB) —		
Raspberry Pi 5 — 16 GB RAM	Raspberry Pi 5 Model B (16 GB) — note: DRAM shortage pricing, ~\$305 as of mid-2026 (was \$120)	raspberrypi.com · Adafruit · PiShop.us (~\$305)
Pironman MAX 5 enclosure	Pironman MAX 5 (tower, dual M.2 NVMe, OLED display, active cooling fans)	52pi.com · Amazon
NVMe SSD × 2 (RAID 1)	1 TB M.2 2280 PCIe Gen 3/4 NVMe (e.g. WD Blue SN580 or Samsung 980) — NAND shortage pricing ~\$180 each as of mid-2026 (was ~\$75)	Amazon · B&H; · Newegg (~\$180 each)
Pi 5 USB-C power supply	Official Raspberry Pi 27W USB-C PD power supply	raspberrypi.com · Adafruit · Amazon
MicroSD card (boot / initial RAID setup)	32 GB Class 10 / A1 microSD (removed after RAID is built)	Amazon
— 44Net Gateway (Pi 5 — 16 GB) —		
Raspberry Pi 5 — 16 GB RAM	Raspberry Pi 5 Model B (16 GB) — dedicated AMPRNet gateway — matches FieldCommand Pi for spare-parts commonality — 8 GB variant (~\$130) also works for gateway-only role if budget is tight	raspberrypi.com · Adafruit · PiShop.us (~\$305)
Argon NEO 5 M.2 BRED case	Argon NEO 5 M.2 BRED (compact, passive-cooled, M.2 SATA slot, aluminum) — fits Pi 5	argon40.com · Amazon (~\$35)
M.2 SATA SSD (gateway OS + config)	256 GB M.2 2242 or 2280 SATA SSD — OS, WireGuard config, routing tables	Amazon · Newegg (~\$25)
Pi 5 USB-C power supply	Official Raspberry Pi 27W USB-C PD power supply — one per Pi	raspberrypi.com · Adafruit · Amazon
— Networking —		
ASUS RT-BE58 Go travel router	ASUS RT-BE58 Go (Wi-Fi 7, 2.5G LAN uplink, USB-C 18W power) — qty: 3 recommended (1 primary + 2 AiMesh nodes)	Amazon · Best Buy · B&H;
UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE	Ubiquiti USW-Lite-16-PoE (16-port GbE, 8× PoE, 2× SFP uplink, 45W PoE budget)	ui.com · Amazon · B&H; (~\$200)
CAT 6 Ethernet cables × 10	1 ft – 6 ft CAT 6 patch cables — router to switch, both Pis, laptop, printer, 4× workstations	Amazon · Monoprice
— Accessories — Backup & Connectivity —		
USB-A drive (32 GB+, labeled FIELDCOMMAND)	32 GB+ USB 3.0 drive — auto-backup trigger when inserted	Amazon

ITEM	MODEL / SPEC	WHERE TO BUY
External USB hard drive 1 TB+ (e.g. LaCie Rugged)	1 TB+ USB 3.0/USB-C portable drive — label FIELDCOMMAND for auto-backup	B&H; · Amazon · Best Buy
USB GPS receiver (optional)	GlobalSat BU-353-S4 or u-blox USB GPS puck — provides live position to tactical map and NWS alerts	Amazon
Powered USB hub (optional)	Anker 7-Port USB 3.0 with AC power adapter — must be powered hub, not bus-powered	Amazon · Best Buy
Avery 5371 business card sheets (operator access cards)	Avery 5371 — 10 cards per sheet, laser or inkjet — for printed operator access cards	Office Depot · Amazon · Staples
— Amateur Radio Equipment (skip if no amateur radio group) —		
USB TNC — Digirig Mobile	Digirig Mobile v1.x — USB soundcard + serial CAT in one compact unit — enables APRS transmit/receive via Direwolf/YAAC and Winlink VHF packet via Pat	digirig.net · Amazon
USB TNC — Signalink USB (alternative)	Tigertronics Signalink USB — USB audio interface — requires rig-specific audio cable — widely used and well-supported	tigertronics.com · Ham Radio Outlet · Amazon
Mobilinkd TNC4 (Bluetooth alternative)	Bluetooth APRS TNC — pairs with YAAC on the Pi or APRSdroid on a phone — useful when a USB port is not available	mobilinkd.com · Amazon
Rig interface cable (for TNC)	Radio-specific audio + PTT cable connecting TNC to transceiver — Digirig: cables at digirig.net by radio model — Signalink: Tigertronics cable for each rig	digirig.net · tigertronics.com · HRO
Windows laptop (Winlink Express + JS8Call)	Any Windows 10/11 laptop with USB-A port and Wi-Fi — required for Winlink Express, VARA HF, and JS8Call — see Part 2E	Best Buy · Amazon
— Printers — Monochrome Laser (USB via CUPS or direct Wi-Fi) —		
Brother HL-L2350DW (recommended)	Monochrome laser — USB + Wi-Fi — excellent Linux driver — fast, duplex, durable	Best Buy · Amazon (~\$130)
HP LaserJet Pro M15w / P1102w	Monochrome laser — USB + Wi-Fi — HPLIP driver auto-installs with CUPS	Best Buy · Amazon (~\$150)
— Printers — Color Multifunction Laser (USB, Wi-Fi, or Ethernet) —		
Brother MFC-L3770CDW	Color laser MFP — print, scan, copy, fax — USB + Wi-Fi + Ethernet — full Linux CUPS support — prints color ICS maps and IAP packages	Amazon · Best Buy (~\$400)
HP Color LaserJet Pro MFP M479fdw	Color laser MFP — print, scan, copy, fax — USB + Wi-Fi + Ethernet — HPLIP driver works out of the box with CUPS	Amazon · B&H; (~\$500)

ITEM	MODEL / SPEC	WHERE TO BUY
Canon imageCLASS MF743Cdw	Color laser MFP — letter + legal — USB + Wi-Fi + Ethernet — Linux CAPT driver — good for permanent EOC installations	Amazon · Office Depot (~\$450)
— Printers — Portable / Battery-Powered (field deployments without shore power) —		
Canon PIXMA TR150	Compact inkjet — built-in rechargeable battery — ~200 pages per charge — USB + Wi-Fi — letter size	Best Buy · Amazon (~\$200)
HP OfficeJet 200	Portable inkjet — larger paper tray — optional battery accessory — USB + Wi-Fi — good for shelter stations	Best Buy · Amazon (~\$180)
— Operator Workstations — Raspberry Pi 500 / 500+ (qty: 4 recommended) —		
Raspberry Pi 500 keyboard computer ×4	Pi 500 standalone — Pi 5 chip, 8 GB RAM, 32 GB A2 microSD, integrated keyboard — one per operator station	raspberrypi.com · Adafruit · Amazon (~\$130 each — DRAM shortage pricing)
Raspberry Pi 500+ ×4 (alternative)	Pi 500+ — same as Pi 500 but with Pi 5 latest revision chip and 2× USB3 — specify if 501(c)(3) funding allows premium spec	raspberrypi.com · Adafruit (~\$410 each — significantly increased by DRAM shortage; standard Pi 500 recommended)
Raspberry Pi Monitor 15.6" ×4	15.6" Full HD IPS touchscreen — built-in speakers — kickstand — VESA mount — USB-C powered from Pi 500 — one per station	raspberrypi.com · GigaParts · Amazon (~\$100 each)
micro-HDMI to HDMI cable ×4	1m micro-HDMI to standard HDMI — Pi 500 to Monitor video connection — one per station	Included in Pi 500 Desktop Kit · Amazon (~\$8 each)
USB-C power supply for Pi 500 ×4	Official Raspberry Pi 27W USB-C PD supply — one per station — Pi 500 can also be powered from Monitor USB-C port	raspberrypi.com · Adafruit (~\$12 each)
Raspberry Pi 500 Desktop Kit ×4 (bundle option)	Pi 500 + official mouse + micro-HDMI cable bundled — add Monitor separately — simpler ordering than individual parts	raspberrypi.com · Amazon (~\$160 each — DRAM shortage pricing)

Amateur Radio Equipment category: These items are only needed if a licensed amateur radio group is the lead or a key partner in the deployment. If FieldCommand is deployed by a public safety agency or served organization without licensed amateur radio operators, skip the entire Amateur Radio Equipment category. See Part 2 of this guide for amateur radio setup procedures.

EMCOMM-NET Coverage Extension — 3× ASUS RT-BE58 Go Total (1 Primary + 2 AiMesh Nodes)

The standard FieldCommand deployment uses three ASUS RT-BE58 Go routers: one configured as the primary (connected to your WAN source and the UniFi switch) and two configured as AiMesh nodes to extend EMMCOMM-NET coverage across large EOC buildings, shelters, and outdoor staging areas. All three are the same hardware — any unit can serve as the primary if needed. All three broadcast the same EMMCOMM-NET SSID and password — devices roam between them automatically with no reconnection required.

ITEM	MODEL / SPEC	WHERE TO BUY
ASUS RT-BE58 Go ×2 (mesh nodes)	ASUS RT-BE58 Go — identical to primary router — pairs instantly as AiMesh node with no extra configuration — extends EMCOMM-NET at full Wi-Fi 7 speed — wired backhaul via UniFi switch ports 11 and 12	Amazon · Best Buy · B&H; (~\$120-150 each)
USB-C power supply ×2 (for mesh nodes)	USB-C 18W PD adapter — one per node — or USB-C power bank (10,000+ mAh, 18W+) for field use without shore power	Amazon (~\$15-25 each)
CAT 6 Ethernet cable ×2 (wired backhaul)	CAT 6 patch cable from UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE to each node LAN port — wired backhaul is strongly recommended — provides full throughput vs wireless backhaul — length as needed for the venue	Amazon · Monoprice · Home Depot (~\$10-20 each)

DEPLOYMENT SCENARIO	RECOMMENDED SETUP
Single room EOC (under 2,500 sq ft)	1× RT-BE58 Go primary only — no extension needed
Multi-room EOC or large shelter (2,500–7,500 sq ft)	1× primary + 1 RT-BE58 Go node — wired backhaul via switch Port 11
Large building or campus (7,500–20,000 sq ft)	1× primary + 2 RT-BE58 Go nodes — wired backhaul via switch Ports 11 and 12
Outdoor SAR staging area	1× primary at command post + 1-2 RT-BE58 Go nodes at field positions on battery

■ All three ASUS RT-BE58 Go routers broadcast the same EMCOMM-NET SSID and password. Operators and devices roam between them automatically — no reconnection, no password re-entry, no awareness of which router they are connected to. Pairing a new node to the primary takes under 5 minutes on site.

SD Card / Storage Sizing Guide

TIER	WHAT FITS / REQUIREMENT
Minimum (boot only)	8 GB — OS only, RAID boot loader. FieldCommand runs from NVMe RAID.
Recommended	32 GB — OS + swap + logs + temp files during initial RAID setup.
Kiwix Tier 1	~3 GB additional on RAID — WikiMed + Wikipedia Mini + Wikivoyage.
Kiwix Tier 2	~10 GB additional on RAID — adds iFixit, Wikibooks, Wikiversity.
FCC Database	~600 MB on RAID — full US amateur license database (~800K records).

1 Flash OS & Build RAID 1 — Do This First

Step 1: Flash the OS and Build the RAID Array

These two tasks must be completed before anything else. The Raspberry Pi OS must be installed and the RAID 1 array assembled before the FieldCommand installer runs. If you are using a single NVMe drive (no RAID), flash the OS to it directly and skip the RAID build section.

Recommended: Automated One-Command Setup

The easiest and least error-prone way to build a field server is the automated setup script. From a single command it does everything the manual Sections 1B and Steps 3–4 describe: it builds the boot-from-RAID-1 mirror across both SSDs, copies the operating system onto it, reboots into the mirror, and then installs and configures FieldCommand IMS for you. You answer a few short questions once at the start (or none at all, if you prepare a configuration file). The step-by-step manual sections that follow are kept as a reference and a fallback — you do not need them if you use the automated setup.

What you do, start to finish:

STEP	WHAT YOU DO
1. Flash the card	With Raspberry Pi Imager, flash Raspberry Pi OS (64-bit, Desktop) to a microSD card. Set the hostname and username as shown in the Imager table in Section 1A below (username fieldcommand).
2. Copy the software onto the card	After imaging, a small drive named bootfs appears on your computer (it is the card's boot partition). Copy the whole FieldCommand-IMS folder onto it. If you downloaded the ZIP from GitHub , it unzips as FieldCommand-IMS-main — rename it to FieldCommand-IMS (drop the “-main”) so the command in Step 3 matches. (Optional: also copy a filled-in fieldcommand.conf — see the sample in the scripts folder — to skip all on-screen questions and run completely unattended.)
3. Boot and run one command	Put the card in the Pi 5, connect a monitor and keyboard, power on, open a terminal, and run:
4. Answer the questions once	Enter your callsign (or leave it blank — see the note below), location, Wi-Fi name, and a few options. The script shows you the two SSDs and asks you to type YES before it erases them, then builds the mirror, reboots into it, and finishes the FieldCommand install by itself.
5. Do the pull-a-drive test	When it finishes, perform the pull-a-drive failover test described at the end of Section 1B. This is the one step only you can do by hand, and it is the whole point of the mirror.

Step 3 – the one command (run on the Pi after first boot):

```
sudo bash /boot/firmware/FieldCommand-IMS/scripts/fieldcommand-setup.sh
```

See exactly what it would do first, changing nothing:

```
sudo bash /boot/firmware/FieldCommand-IMS/scripts/fieldcommand-setup.sh --dry-run
```

■ Callsign is **OPTIONAL**. Leave it blank if your group has no amateur radio operators — the program works fully without it and simply keeps the Amateur Radio tools grayed out. Enter a callsign **ONLY** if you have a properly licensed amateur radio operator with operating privileges on the specific bands and modes you intend to use; transmitting on the amateur bands without such a licensed operator is unlawful. You can add a callsign later in the Setup wizard at any time to turn these features on.

■ Install **BOTH** NVMe SSDs in the Pironman before you begin — the setup builds a mirror across the two drives and will stop if it finds only one. The setup script **ERASES BOTH** NVMe SSDs (it confirms the exact drives with you first). Booting a Raspberry Pi 5 from a RAID array goes slightly beyond SunFounder's own documented single-drive boot, so bench-test the whole flow — including the pull-a-drive test — on your actual hardware before relying on it in the field. Run with **--dry-run** first to preview every action.

Alternative — download on the Pi instead of copying to the card. If the Pi has internet, you can skip copying the folder and instead run the bootstrap one-liner, which downloads FieldCommand and launches the same setup:

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/KE4CON/FieldCommand-IMS/main/scripts/bootstrap.sh | sudo bash
```

1A Flash the Operating System

OS EDITION	PROS	CONS
Raspberry Pi OS Lite (64-bit) — Recommended for production	Minimal overhead. All RAM available to FieldCommand. Fast boot. Smaller attack surface.	No local browser or GUI — configuration via SSH from your laptop. FieldCommand itself is always accessed from EMCOMM-NET devices, not the Pi directly.
Raspberry Pi OS Desktop (64-bit) — Good for setup and troubleshooting	Local browser for testing. GUI for initial Wi-Fi setup and configuration. Easier for new users.	More RAM used by desktop environment. Slightly longer install time.
Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS — Also supported	LTS kernel. Familiar to Linux admins. Long-term package support.	Some package names differ from Raspberry Pi OS. Slightly more manual setup.

Use **Raspberry Pi Imager** (download from raspberrypi.com/software) to flash the OS to either a microSD card (for single-drive setup) or directly to the NVMe SSD (if not using RAID). During the Imager advanced options, set:

IMAGER OPTION	VALUE / REASON
Hostname	fieldcommand.local — makes the Pi discoverable as fieldcommand.local on the network
Username	fieldcommand — the FieldCommand installer expects this username
Password	Choose a strong password and record it — required for SSH and CUPS admin
Enable SSH	Lite: Yes — required (only access method without a display). Desktop: Recommended for remote diagnostics, but optional if you have a monitor and keyboard connected to the Pi.
Wi-Fi	Set your home or lab Wi-Fi during initial OS setup. EMCOMM-NET comes later.
Locale / Timezone	US/Central for local operations

1B Build the Boot-Mirror (Pironman 5 MAX — Dual NVMe RAID 1)

The Pironman 5 MAX carries two M.2 NVMe slots on a SunFounder Dual NVMe PIP board. That board uses an ASMedia ASM1182e PCIe switch to split the Pi 5's single PCIe Gen 2 x1 lane into two independent Gen 2 x1 lanes — one per slot. Both slots are electrically equivalent: there is no dedicated "boot slot," and the boot drive is chosen by firmware boot order and the PARTUUID in cmdline.txt, not by which slot a drive sits in. We mirror the two drives as a RAID 1 array so that if one SSD dies the Pi keeps running on the survivor with the live incident data intact. Skip this whole section if you are using a single NVMe drive.

This is boot-from-RAID, not just a data mirror: the goal is that the Pi boots AND keeps running on EITHER drive alone. That means the boot files must live on BOTH drives, not only the mirrored root. SunFounder's own docs cover single-NVMe boot and two independent bootable NVMe systems, but not a booting RAID 1 — so follow every sub-step here, and do NOT skip the pull-a-drive test at the end. That test is the only proof the mirror actually fails over on your hardware.

Complete the mirror BEFORE running the FieldCommand installer — the installer must run on the final storage configuration. If your OS is already running from a single drive, back it up before proceeding.

Pironman / PCIe Prerequisite (do this first — both drives must be visible)

Before the Pi will see BOTH NVMe drives through the PCIe switch, the firmware must be told the PCIe port is present and given time to bring the switch up. Boot the microSD OS, then edit **/boot/firmware/config.txt** and add the two SunFounder-required lines:

```

sudo nano /boot/firmware/config.txt

# --- Pironman 5 MAX Dual NVMe PIP (ASM1182e PCIe switch) ---
dtparam=pciex1 # enable the Pi 5 PCIe x1 port (alias: dtparam=nvme)
dtparam=pciex1_no_10s=on # disable the PCIe boot delay so BOTH drives behind the
# switch are detected at startup (required for dual NVMe)
#
# Do NOT force Gen 3 – the ASM1182e is a Gen 2 switch. Leave the link at Gen 2.
# (No pciex1_gen=3 line. Gen 3 is not supported on this board.)

```

Reboot, then confirm BOTH drives are present before going any further:

```

lsblk -d -o NAME,SIZE,MODEL | grep nvme
# Expected: BOTH nvme0n1 and nvme1n1 listed, each ~1 TB.
# If only one appears, STOP – recheck the two config.txt lines and the FFC cable seating.

```

Physical Installation

SLOT	DRIVE	LINUX DEVICE NAME
M.2 Slot A (either slot)	1 TB NVMe SSD (e.g. WD Blue SN580)	/dev/nvme0n1
M.2 Slot B (either slot)	1 TB NVMe SSD — identical model recommended	/dev/nvme1n1

The two slots are interchangeable — which physical drive becomes nvme0n1 vs nvme1n1 does not matter for a mirror. Use identical drives so the array is balanced and rebuilds cleanly.

Partition Both Drives Identically

Boot from a Raspberry Pi OS Lite microSD to do the setup. Each NVMe drive gets a small FAT boot partition — firmware reads that directly, because firmware CANNOT read a RAID array — plus a large Linux partition for the mirrored root. Do this to BOTH drives:

```

# Repeat for /dev/nvme0n1 AND /dev/nvme1n1
sudo parted /dev/nvme0n1 --script mklabel gpt
sudo parted /dev/nvme0n1 --script mkpart primary fat32 1MiB 513MiB
sudo parted /dev/nvme0n1 --script set 1 boot on
sudo parted /dev/nvme0n1 --script mkpart primary 513MiB 100%
# p1 = 512 MB FAT boot partition p2 = rest of the drive (Linux RAID)

# ...then the same four commands again for /dev/nvme1n1

```

Build the RAID 1 Root and Mirror the Boot Files

```
# Install the tools
sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get install -y mdadm rsync dosfstools

# Mirror the two large partitions as the root array
sudo mdadm --create --verbose /dev/md0 --level=1 --raid-devices=2 \
/dev/nvme0n1p2 /dev/nvme1n1p2
cat /proc/mdstat # watch the resync (~15 min for 1 TB)

# Root filesystem on the array; FAT on EACH boot partition
sudo mkfs.ext4 -L fc-root /dev/md0
sudo mkfs.vfat -F 32 /dev/nvme0n1p1
sudo mkfs.vfat -F 32 /dev/nvme1n1p1

# Copy the running OS root onto the array
sudo mkdir -p /mnt/root && sudo mount /dev/md0 /mnt/root
sudo rsync -axHAX --info=progress2 / /mnt/root/

# Copy the boot files onto BOTH drives' FAT partitions
sudo mkdir -p /mnt/boot0 /mnt/boot1
sudo mount /dev/nvme0n1p1 /mnt/boot0
sudo mount /dev/nvme1n1p1 /mnt/boot1
sudo cp -a /boot/firmware/. /mnt/boot0/
sudo cp -a /boot/firmware/. /mnt/boot1/

# Make the array assemble automatically at boot
sudo mkdir -p /mnt/root/etc/mdadm
sudo mdadm --detail --scan | sudo tee /mnt/root/etc/mdadm/mdadm.conf
```

Point the Boot Files at the Array

On BOTH boot partitions (/mnt/boot0 and /mnt/boot1) edit two files so either drive can boot the mirror:

FILE (on each boot partition)	CHANGE
cmdline.txt	Point root at the array and allow it time to assemble: replace the existing root=PARTUUID=... with root=/dev/md0 rootdelay=10 — keep the rest of the line intact.
config.txt	Keep the two Pironman PCIe lines from the prerequisite step, and add auto_initramfs=1 so the initramfs that assembles the RAID is built and loaded at boot.

In the array's /etc/fstab, mount /boot/firmware with the **nofail** option so a missing drive never blocks boot. Then rebuild the initramfs and set the firmware to boot from NVMe:

```
sudo update-initramfs -u -k all

# Set the Pi 5 bootloader to try NVMe (applies to both slots)
sudo raspi-config # Advanced Options > Boot Order > NVMe/USB Boot

sudo poweroff # remove the microSD card, then power back on
```

Verify — Then PULL A DRIVE (do not skip)

After the Pi boots from NVMe with the SD card removed, confirm the mirror is healthy, then prove it actually fails over. For a keep-going server, this test is the whole point of the mirror:

```
cat /proc/mdstat
# Expected: md0 : active raid1 nvme0n1p2[0] nvme1n1p2[1] [UU]

# --- Pull-a-drive failover test ---
# 1. sudo poweroff. Remove drive A. Power on.
# -> Pi MUST boot and FieldCommand MUST come up on drive B alone.
# 2. sudo poweroff. Re-insert A, remove drive B instead. Power on.
# -> Pi MUST boot on drive A alone.
# 3. sudo poweroff. Re-insert both. Power on. Re-add the drive that was out:
# sudo mdadm /dev/md0 --add /dev/nvme1n1p2 (whichever shows missing)
# cat /proc/mdstat -> watch it resync back to [UU].
```

If the Pi does NOT boot with one drive removed, the mirror is not truly redundant yet — usually the boot files were not copied to that drive's FAT partition, or the bootloader boot order does not include NVMe. Fix it and re-test until BOTH single-drive cases boot on their own. A mirror you have not tested by pulling a drive is a mirror you cannot rely on in the field.

RAID STATUS	MEANING	ACTION REQUIRED
[UU] (both drives active)	Normal — both drives healthy and in sync	None
[U_] or [_U] (one drive failed)	One drive has failed. Pi is still running on the other.	Power down. Replace failed drive. Run: <code>sudo mdadm /dev/md0 --add /dev/nvme1n1</code> . Array rebuilds automatically.
Resync in progress	Array is rebuilding — normal after first setup or drive replacement	Leave running. Takes 15 – 30 minutes. Pi is usable during rebuild.

RAID 1 protects against drive failure — it is NOT a backup. Both drives contain identical data, so accidental deletion affects both drives simultaneously. Continue to use the FIELDCOMMAND USB auto-backup for regular data backups.

2. Before You Begin — Prerequisites

Complete these prerequisites before running the installer. The installer requires an internet connection for package downloads, the FCC database, and Kiwix ZIM files. After installation, the server operates fully offline.

2.1 Flash the Operating System

OS EDITION	PROS	CONS
Raspberry Pi OS Lite (64-bit) — Recommended for production	Minimal overhead, faster boot, all RAM available to FieldCommand services, smaller attack surface	No local browser or GUI — configuration via SSH from your laptop. FieldCommand is accessed from EMCOMM-NET devices, not from the Pi itself.
Raspberry Pi OS Desktop (64-bit) — Good for setup and troubleshooting	GUI for initial setup, Raspberry Pi Configuration tool, local browser for testing	More RAM used by desktop environment; install takes longer
Ubuntu Server 24.04 LTS — Also supported	LTS kernel, familiar to Linux admins, good for organizations standardized on Ubuntu	Slightly larger memory footprint; some package names differ

2.2 First Boot — Initial Setup

STEP	ACTION
1	On first boot, complete the initial setup wizard: set username to fieldcommand , set a strong password, configure locale and keyboard, expand filesystem.
2	If using Desktop edition: complete the initial desktop setup wizard.
3	Lite only — Enable SSH: run <code>sudo raspi-config</code> → Interface Options → SSH → Enable. Desktop users skip this step — use the local terminal instead of SSH for all remaining steps.

Run a full system update before installing FieldCommand (works the same on both editions — Terminal or SSH):

```
# Update all packages to latest versions
sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get full-upgrade -y
# Reboot to apply kernel updates
sudo reboot
```

2.3 Verify Disk Space

```
# Check available space – should show 20GB+ free for Tier 2 install
df -h /
# Verify RAM
free -h
```

2.4 Internet Connection

Connect the Pi to the internet via Ethernet before running the installer. Wi-Fi can be used during initial setup but Ethernet is strongly preferred for downloading large files — the FCC database is ~600 MB and Kiwix ZIMs range from 500 MB to 25 GB.

2.5 Operator Workstation — Browser Options

FieldCommand runs entirely in a web browser. Any modern browser on any device connected to EMCOMM-NET works. For the Raspberry Pi 500 / 500+ used as an operator workstation, three browsers are available:

BROWSER	HOW TO INSTALL	NOTES FOR FIELDCOMMAND
Chromium (default)	Pre-installed on Raspberry Pi OS. No action needed.	Best performance for FieldCommand. Discovers CUPS printers automatically via Bonjour. Set http://192.168.50.1 as the startup page under Settings → On startup.
Firefox ESR	<code>sudo apt install firefox-esr</code>	Excellent compatibility with all FieldCommand pages. Good fallback if Chromium behaves unexpectedly. Also discovers network printers. Slightly lower memory footprint on the Pi 500.
GNOME Web (Epiphany)	<code>sudo apt install epiphany-browser</code>	Very lightweight WebKit browser. Good for Pi 500 with many tabs open. Best for dedicated check-in stations where memory is tight.



For dedicated FieldCommand operator stations running Pi 500: set Chromium to open <http://192.168.50.1> on startup. In Chromium: Settings → On startup → Open a specific page → enter <http://192.168.50.1>. The dashboard loads automatically every time the Pi 500 boots.



Wi-Fi is provided by the ASUS RT-BE58 Go router — the Pi does NOT run hostapd. During installation, connect the Pi to the internet via Ethernet through the UniFi switch and ASUS router. After installation, the Pi is always reachable at 192.168.50.1 via wired Ethernet.

2

Network Hardware Setup — ASUS Router + UniFi Switch

Step 2: Network Hardware Setup — ASUS Router + UniFi Switch

Complete this step before running the FieldCommand installer. The ASUS router must be configured with the correct LAN subnet (192.168.50.x) before FieldCommand is reachable at <http://192.168.50.1>.

Physical Wiring

The UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE is the central wiring hub for the entire EMCOMM-NET deployment. Connect everything to the switch, and the switch connects up to the ASUS router. Use short CAT 6 patch cables (1 ft to 3 ft) to keep the rack or case tidy. The primary cellular modem or antenna connects directly to the ASUS WAN port via its PoE Ethernet cable — this is completely separate from the switch and does not use a switch port.

CONNECTION	DEVICE	IP / NOTES
ASUS WAN port (PoE Ethernet)	Cellular antenna (primary WAN)	Primary internet — PoE cable from outdoor cellular modem/antenna directly to ASUS WAN port. Cellular modem serves DHCP on its own subnet — ASUS bridges to EMCOMM-NET.
ASUS USB WAN port (USB-to-Ethernet)	Satellite dish (secondary WAN)	Secondary internet — satellite. satellite Ethernet adapter → USB-to-Ethernet adapter → ASUS USB port. ASUS switches automatically when cellular WAN drops.
Switch Port 1 (uplink)	ASUS RT-BE58 Go LAN port	Uplink from router to switch. Router is DHCP server for 192.168.50.0/24.
Port 2	FieldCommand Pi 5 (Pironman MAX 5)	192.168.50.1 — All browser tools live here.
Port 3	44Net Gateway Pi 5 (Argon NEO 5)	192.168.50.2 — AMPRNet WireGuard gateway.
Port 4	Windows Laptop (Winlink + JS8Call)	192.168.50.3 (static reservation) — or via EMCOMM-NET Wi-Fi.
Port 5	Color MFP Network Printer	192.168.50.10 (recommended static reservation) — auto-discovered by all devices via Bonjour.
Ports 6 – 9	Pi 500 Operator Workstations (up to 4)	192.168.50.20 – 192.168.50.23 (static DHCP reservations)
Port 10	Satellite dish router (optional)	Optional — connect satellite Ethernet to switch as WAN source on ASUS router.
Port 11	ASUS RT-BE58 Go — Mesh Node 1	Wired backhaul to first mesh node. Extends EMCOMM-NET to secondary coverage zone.
Port 12	ASUS RT-BE58 Go — Mesh Node 2	Wired backhaul to second mesh node. Extends EMCOMM-NET to third coverage zone.
Ports 13 – 16	Spare	Available for additional devices, IP radios, second TNC, or future expansion.

DEVICE	POWER SOURCE
ASUS RT-BE58 Go router	USB-C 18W PD adapter — or USB-C power bank for field use

DEVICE	POWER SOURCE
UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE	Included 45W AC power supply
FieldCommand Pi 5 (Pironman MAX 5)	Official Raspberry Pi 27W USB-C PD supply via Pironman MAX 5 power inlet
44Net Gateway Pi 5 (Argon NEO 5)	Official Raspberry Pi 27W USB-C PD supply directly to Pi USB-C port

Configure the ASUS RT-BE58 Go

STEP	ACTION
1	Power on the router. Connect a device to it via Wi-Fi (default SSID on label) or Ethernet. Open http://192.168.50.1 (or the default router IP on the label).
2	Complete the router setup wizard. When it asks for WAN, choose Automatic IP (DHCP) or skip if no internet is connected.
3	Go to LAN → LAN IP . Set the LAN IP to 192.168.50.1 , subnet 255.255.255.0 . Apply.
4	Go to LAN → DHCP Server . Set IP pool: 192.168.50.100 – 192.168.50.200 . Apply.
5	Change the ASUS router admin password to something strong. Record it on a piece of paper stored on the FIELDCOMMAND USB drive.
6	Set Manually Assigned IP for the Pi: go to LAN → DHCP Server → Manually Assigned IP . Enter the Pi's MAC address → assign IP 192.168.50.1 . (Or set the Pi's static IP manually in Step 4.)
7	Set the Wi-Fi SSID: go to Wireless → General . Set both the 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz SSIDs to EMCOMM-NET . Set a strong WPA3/WPA2 password. Apply.

The ASUS RT-BE58 Go supports dual WAN with automatic failover between a primary and secondary internet source. When both WAN sources are unavailable, FieldCommand continues operating on all local features without interruption — net logging, ICS platform, APRS, and all tools remain fully functional.

FieldCommand supports any WAN source your ASUS router can connect to: cellular modem or antenna (PoE Ethernet to WAN port), satellite dish (via Ethernet adapter to USB WAN), site Ethernet, USB smartphone tether, or venue Wi-Fi (WISP mode). Configure your specific WAN hardware according to that device's documentation, then connect it to the ASUS router as shown in the table below. See the ESV Installation Guide for specific WAN hardware configuration.

INTERNET SOURCE	ASUS CONNECTION	HOW TO CONNECT	ROLE
Cellular modem or antenna (PoE Ethernet)	WAN Ethernet port	Run PoE Ethernet cable from the outdoor modem/antenna directly to the ASUS WAN port. Set WAN type → Automatic IP (DHCP). The modem serves DHCP on its own subnet — ASUS bridges to EMMCOMM-NET.	Primary or secondary — your group chooses based on available equipment
Satellite dish (Ethernet adapter)	ASUS USB WAN port (via USB-to-Ethernet adapter)	Satellite Ethernet adapter → USB-to-Ethernet adapter → ASUS USB port. Enable Dual WAN in ASUS admin and configure failover order.	Primary or secondary — your group chooses based on available equipment
EOC or site wired Ethernet	WAN Ethernet port	Plug site Ethernet cable into the ASUS WAN port. Set WAN type → Automatic IP (DHCP).	Good primary when site has reliable wired internet — low cost, no hardware needed

INTERNET SOURCE	ASUS CONNECTION	HOW TO CONNECT	ROLE
USB smartphone tether	ASUS USB WAN port	Enable hotspot on phone. Connect USB cable from phone to the ASUS USB port. Set WAN → USB Tethering in ASUS admin.	Last resort — when no other WAN source is available at the site
Venue Wi-Fi (WISP mode)	ASUS wireless WAN	ASUS admin → Operation Mode → Wireless ISP (WISP). Select the venue Wi-Fi network and enter the password.	When the site has existing guest Wi-Fi — hospital, shelter, or venue

AiMesh Mesh Node Setup — Extending EMCOMM-NET Coverage

The standard FieldCommand deployment includes three ASUS RT-BE58 Go routers: one primary (connected to the WAN source and the UniFi switch) and two mesh nodes that extend EMCOMM-NET to additional rooms, floors, or outdoor areas. All three use the same hardware, the same SSID, and the same password. Devices roam between them automatically.

■ Connect the two mesh nodes via wired Ethernet backhaul (switch Ports 11 and 12) rather than wireless backhaul whenever possible. Wired backhaul provides full Wi-Fi 7 throughput on both upstream and downstream — wireless backhaul cuts bandwidth roughly in half because the node uses its radios for both the backhaul link and the client connections simultaneously.

Repeat these steps for each of the two mesh nodes:

STEP	ACTION
1	Connect the node Ethernet — run a CAT 6 cable from UniFi Switch Port 11 (first node) or Port 12 (second node) to the LAN port of the mesh node router. This is the wired backhaul — it carries all traffic between the node and the primary.
2	Power on the node — connect the USB-C power supply to the mesh node. For initial pairing, position the node within 30 feet of the primary router. After pairing it can be moved to its final location.
3	Open AiMesh on the primary router — go to http://192.168.50.254 → AiMesh → AiMesh Node . The new node appears in the device list within 1-2 minutes.
4	Click Connect on the new node. The primary router pushes the EMCOMM-NET SSID, password, and configuration to the node automatically. This takes 1-3 minutes.
5	Move the node to its final position — mount or place it in the coverage area it needs to serve. The wired backhaul cable connects back to the UniFi switch. Test coverage with a phone on EMCOMM-NET at the furthest point in the area.
6	Verify in AiMesh dashboard — on the primary router, AiMesh → AiMesh Node should show both nodes as Connected with backhaul type Ethernet. Green status on both nodes confirms the mesh is fully operational.

NODE	SWITCH PORT	RECOMMENDED PLACEMENT
Primary RT-BE58 Go (AiMesh controller)	Uplink to ASUS 2.5G LAN port	Central to the deployment — EOC command post or entrance area
RT-BE58 Go — Mesh Node 1	UniFi Switch Port 11	Secondary room, opposite wing, or upper floor
RT-BE58 Go — Mesh Node 2	UniFi Switch Port 12	Third coverage zone — outdoor staging, parking, or far building wing

3

Download & Run the FieldCommand Installer

Step 3: Download & Run the FieldCommand Installer

Method A — Direct download to the Pi (requires internet on Pi)

Lite: SSH into the Pi and run these commands. **Desktop:** open a Terminal window (taskbar → Terminal) and run the same commands.

```
# Create working directory
mkdir -p ~/fieldcommand-install && cd ~/fieldcommand-install
# Download the FieldCommand package from GitHub or your storage location
wget -O fieldcommand-v1.zip
https://github.com/KE4CON/FieldCommand-IMS/releases/latest/download/fieldcommand-v1.zip
# Unzip the package
unzip fieldcommand-v1.zip
cd fieldcommand
```

Method B — Copy from your computer using SCP (Lite/headless)

```
# Run this on YOUR COMPUTER, not the Pi
scp fieldcommand-v1.zip fieldcommand@[pi-ip-address]:~/
# Then SSH into the Pi and unzip
ssh fieldcommand@[pi-ip-address]
mkdir -p ~/fieldcommand-install
mv fieldcommand-v1.zip ~/fieldcommand-install/
cd ~/fieldcommand-install && unzip fieldcommand-v1.zip
cd fieldcommand
```

Method B2 — Download directly on the Pi Desktop (Desktop edition)

OPTION	HOW
Browser download	Open Chromium on the Pi. Go to the GitHub releases page or download URL. Download fieldcommand-v1.zip — it saves to ~/Downloads/ automatically.
USB drive	Copy fieldcommand-v1.zip to a USB drive. Insert the USB into the Pi. Open File Manager, drag the zip to your home folder.

```
# If downloaded to ~/Downloads/:
mkdir -p ~/fieldcommand-install
cp ~/Downloads/fieldcommand-v1.zip ~/fieldcommand-install/
# Unzip (same for all methods):
cd ~/fieldcommand-install && unzip fieldcommand-v1.zip
cd fieldcommand
```

Method C — USB drive transfer (fully offline)

Lite: commands below via SSH. **Desktop:** use File Manager to copy the zip from USB to your home folder, then open a Terminal for the unzip step.

```
# Copy fieldcommand-v1.zip to a USB drive on your computer
# Insert USB drive into the Pi, then:
sudo mount /dev/sda1 /mnt # or check lsblk for your device
cp /mnt/fieldcommand-v1.zip ~/fieldcommand-install/
cd ~/fieldcommand-install && unzip fieldcommand-v1.zip
cd fieldcommand
```

Launch the Installer

Lite: run via SSH. **Desktop:** open a Terminal window from the taskbar or Accessories → Terminal. The installer runs identically on both.

```
cd ~/fieldcommand-install/fieldcommand
sudo bash scripts/install.sh
```

4 Installer Configuration Options

Step 4: Installer Configuration Options

PROMPT	DEFAULT	DESCRIPTION
Station callsign	W8ABC	Your amateur callsign. Patched into all HTML pages.
Station latitude	42.3153	Decimal degrees. Used for APRS station marker, NWS alerts, propagation, distance calc.
Station longitude	-88.4473	Decimal degrees (negative = West). Default 0.0/0.0 — set to your deployment coordinates.
Wi-Fi AP SSID	EMCOMM-NET	The Wi-Fi network name that field devices connect to.
Wi-Fi AP password	fieldcommand2026	WPA2 password for EMMCOMM-NET. Change this for operational security.
Server IP address	192.168.50.1	The Pi's static IP on EMMCOMM-NET. Devices browse to http://192.168.50.1/
Download FCC database	N	~600 MB download of the FCC amateur license database. Recommended: Y
Kiwix tier	1	Tier 1: WikiMed + Wikipedia Mini + Wikivoyage (~2.5 GB). Tier 2 adds iFixit (~5 GB more).

What the Installer Does Automatically

- Installs system packages: Python 3, nginx, kiwix-tools, rsync, gpsd, ufw, mdadm, java
- Creates the **fieldcommand** system user and directory structure at /opt/fieldcommand/
- Creates a Python virtual environment and installs Flask, flask-cors, requests, gpsd-py3
- Deploys all 30 HTML pages to /opt/fieldcommand/html/ and patches your callsign and coordinates into each file
- Installs all 14 systemd service and timer units and enables them at boot
- Configures nginx with the correct web root (/opt/fieldcommand/html/) and proxy rules for all API ports
- **Does NOT configure a Wi-Fi access point** — Wi-Fi is handled by the ASUS RT-BE58 Go router. The Pi connects as a wired client only.
- Configures the Pi static IP (192.168.50.1/24) on the Ethernet interface (eth0) via NetworkManager
- Configures the firewall (ufw) — opens all required ports
- Installs Direwolf (via apt) as the software TNC and YAAC (Java APRS client, /opt/yaac/)
- Installs the USB backup udev rule (plug in a USB drive labeled FIELDCOMMAND to trigger auto-backup)
- Downloads and installs Pat Winlink (browser-based Winlink backup client, port 8090)
- Runs the Kiwix ZIM downloader for the selected content tier
- Downloads the FEMA ICS forms PDFs to /opt/fieldcommand/data/ics_forms/ (22 forms)
- Optionally downloads and builds the FCC amateur license database (~600 MB)
- Starts all services and verifies they are running



The ASUS RT-BE58 Go router must be configured before running the installer — see Step 1. The Pi does NOT run hostapd or dnsmasq. All Wi-Fi, DHCP, and SSID management is handled by the ASUS router.

4b

RAID 1 NVMe Setup

Step 4b: RAID 1 NVMe Setup — Pironman MAX 5

The Pironman 5 MAX enclosure has two M.2 NVMe slots. We configure them as a RAID 1 mirror so both drives contain identical data in real time; if one drive fails, the system keeps running on the survivor with the live incident data intact.

■ The full, authoritative boot-mirror procedure is in STEP 1, Section 1B — and it must be completed BEFORE the FieldCommand installer runs, so it is done first. Do NOT follow a shorter RAID recipe here: booting from RAID on the Pi 5 requires a FAT boot partition on BOTH drives, the two Pironman PCIe lines in config.txt (dtparam=pciex1 and dtparam=pciex1_no_10s=on), an initramfs that assembles the array, and the pull-a-drive failover test. All of that is in Section 1B. This step is a quick reference back to it plus the RAID health table below.

RAID Health Reference

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
Both drives show [UU]	Normal healthy state. No action needed.
One drive fails — [_U] or [U_]	1. Power down. 2. Replace the failed NVMe. 3. Power on. 4. Re-create its two partitions (p1 FAT boot, p2 RAID) as in Section 1B and copy the boot files onto the new p1. 5. Run: <code>sudo mdadm /dev/md0 --add /dev/nvmeXn1p2</code> (the new drive). 6. Array rebuilds automatically (~30 min).
Check RAID health anytime	<code>cat /proc/mdstat</code> or <code>sudo mdadm --detail /dev/md0</code>

■ RAID 1 protects against drive failure — it is NOT a backup. Both drives contain identical data, so accidental deletion or corruption affects both drives simultaneously. Continue to use the USB auto-backup (insert FIELDCOMMAND USB drive) for regular data backups.

5 Raspberry Pi 5 — Static IP Configuration

Step 5: Raspberry Pi 5 — Static IP Configuration

The Pi must always be reachable at 192.168.50.1. If the installer already set this via a DHCP reservation in the ASUS router, verify with `ip addr show eth0` and skip to Step 5 if 192.168.50.1/24 is shown.

Choose the path that matches your OS edition: Path A is for Raspberry Pi OS Lite users who configure the Pi over SSH from their laptop. Path B is for Raspberry Pi OS Desktop users who have a monitor and keyboard connected — use the Pi's own terminal, no SSH required. If you used `raspi-config` during OS setup, use Path C.

Path A — Raspberry Pi OS Lite (via SSH from your laptop)

```
# SSH into the Pi (use the IP shown in your router DHCP table)
ssh fieldcommand@[current-pi-ip]
# Find the Ethernet connection name
nmcli con show
# Usually: "Wired connection 1" or "Preconfigured Connection 1"
# Set static IP
sudo nmcli con mod "Wired connection 1" ipv4.addresses 192.168.50.1/24 ipv4.method manual
# Apply the change
sudo nmcli con up "Wired connection 1"
# Verify — should show inet 192.168.50.1/24
ip addr show eth0
```

Path B — Raspberry Pi OS Desktop (via Terminal on the Pi)

STEP	ACTION
1	Click the network icon in the taskbar (top-right corner).
2	Click Advanced Options → Edit Connections .
3	Select your Wired connection and click the gear/edit icon.
4	Click the IPv4 Settings tab.
5	Change Method from "Automatic (DHCP)" to Manual .
6	Click Add and enter: Address: 192.168.50.1 · Netmask: 255.255.255.0 · Gateway: (leave blank)
7	Click Save , then close the Network Connections window.
8	Disconnect and reconnect the Ethernet cable, or reboot the Pi.
9	Open the Terminal and verify: <code>ip addr show eth0</code> — should show inet 192.168.50.1/24 .
10	Open Chromium on the Pi and go to <code>http://192.168.50.1</code> to confirm FieldCommand loads locally.

Alternatively, open a Terminal on the desktop and use the same `nmcli` commands shown in Path A. The terminal method works identically on the Desktop edition.

Path C — `raspi-config` (if available)


```
# Open raspi-config:
sudo raspi-config
# Navigate to: System Options → Network → (set static IP if option is present)
# NOTE: Static IP configuration via raspi-config was removed in Raspberry Pi OS Bookworm.
# If the option is not visible, use Path A (nmcli) or Path B (GUI Network Connections).
```

6

Kiwix Offline Library Setup

Step 6: Kiwix Offline Library Setup

Kiwix provides an offline web library served on port 8081. All devices on EMCOMM-NET can browse it at <http://192.168.50.1:8081>. Content is packaged as ZIM files.

TIER	NAME	SIZE	DESCRIPTION
Essential	WikiMed — Medical Encyclopedia	~471 MB	Offline medical encyclopedia: symptoms, treatments, drugs, procedures. Critical for mass-casualty events.
Essential	Wikipedia (Mini)	~1.2 GB	Compact English Wikipedia — essential facts, geography, science.
Essential	Wikivoyage	~820 MB	Emergency shelters, evacuation routes, local resources and travel logistics.
Extended	Wikibooks — How-To & Field Manuals	~4.2 GB	First aid, survival, ham radio, electronics, cooking, field skills.
Extended	iFixit — Equipment Repair Manuals	~3.1 GB	Step-by-step repair guides for electronics, tools, vehicles.
Extended	Wikipedia (Full English)	~22 GB	Complete English Wikipedia. Large download — requires 30 GB+ free.

```
# Check what is installed and service status
sudo bash /opt/fieldcommand/scripts/kiwix_setup.sh --status

# Add Tier 2 content (resumes interrupted downloads automatically)
sudo bash /opt/fieldcommand/scripts/kiwix_setup.sh --tier 2

# Service management
sudo systemctl status kiwix
sudo systemctl restart kiwix # required after adding new ZIM files
```

ZIM downloads are resumable. If a download is interrupted by power loss or network drop, simply re-run `kiwix_setup.sh` with the same `--tier` flag. `curl` resumes from where it stopped — no need to start over.

Additional Kiwix Content — Install Any ZIM File

Kiwix.org (kiwix.org/en/content/) publishes hundreds of ZIM archives beyond the two built-in tiers. Any ZIM file can be added to FieldCommand. The following table lists the most useful additions for emergency communications and public safety operations:

CONTENT	APPROX SIZE	BEST FOR
OpenStreetMap (Wikimedia Maps)	~500 MB	Offline detailed maps for any region. Download your county or state for SAR and shelter mapping.
Stack Overflow (programming Q&A;)	~3.5 GB	Technical troubleshooting reference. Useful for net managers debugging FieldCommand.
Project Gutenberg (public domain books)	~65 GB (full) / ~1 GB (best-of)	Field reference library. Includes FCC regulations, ARRL handbook excerpts, first aid guides.

CONTENT	APPROX SIZE	BEST FOR
Khan Academy (education)	~30 GB	Training resource for shelter and EOC staff during extended activations.
Red Cross First Aid (WikiMed companion)	~200 MB	Practical first aid procedures in plain language — supplements WikiMed for non-medical staff.
Wiktionary (dictionary)	~520 MB	Reference for unfamiliar ICS terminology and acronyms.
Amateur Radio Wiki (if available)	Variable	Band plans, antenna theory, Winlink and APRS procedures.

How to Install Any ZIM File

```
# Step 1 – Find and download the ZIM from a device with internet
# Browse to: https://library.kiwix.org
# Filter by language (English) and category.
# Download the .zim file to your laptop or phone.

# Step 2 – Transfer the ZIM to the Pi
# Option A: USB drive (copy to USB, insert in Pi)
sudo mount /dev/sda1 /mnt
cp /mnt/my_content.zim /opt/kiwix/zim/

# Option B: SCP from your laptop over EMCOMM-NET
scp my_content.zim fieldcommand@192.168.50.1:/opt/kiwix/zim/

# Step 3 – Register the new ZIM with the Kiwix library index
sudo kiwix-manage /opt/kiwix/library.xml add /opt/kiwix/zim/my_content.zim

# Step 4 – Restart Kiwix to load the new content
sudo systemctl restart kiwix

# Step 5 – Verify it appears at http://192.168.50.1:8081
# The new content appears in the Kiwix home page search bar.

# To list all installed ZIM files:
ls -lh /opt/kiwix/zim/

# To remove a ZIM file:
sudo rm /opt/kiwix/zim/my_content.zim
sudo systemctl restart kiwix
```

ZIM files can be large. Check available disk space before downloading: `df -h /opt/kiwix/` The RAID array provides 2× 1 TB = ~900 GB usable after OS and FieldCommand. Tier 1 uses ~2.5 GB. Tier 2 uses ~10 GB. There is ample space for additional content.

7

Printer Setup

Step 7: Printer Setup

FieldCommand has print buttons on 17 pages. All printing uses the browser standard `window.print()` function, which sends the job to whatever printer the operator's browser can reach. Three printer connection methods are supported:

Option A — Client Device Prints to Its Own Printer (Simplest)

Each operator's laptop or tablet prints to its own locally connected printer. No Pi configuration needed. Zero setup required — works immediately.



This is the simplest option and requires zero configuration on the Pi. The only requirement is that the operator's device has a printer configured.

Option B — USB Printer Shared via Pi (CUPS)

A USB printer is connected directly to the Pi. CUPS shares it across EMCOMM-NET. Installed automatically by the FieldCommand installer. CUPS admin UI at <http://192.168.50.1:631>.

B.2 Add the USB Printer via CUPS Web Admin

STEP	ACTION
1	Plug the USB printer into one of the Pi's USB ports (or powered USB hub).
2	On any device on EMCOMM-NET, open a browser and go to: http://192.168.50.1:631
3	Click Administration → Add Printer .
4	If prompted for credentials, enter the Pi username and password (e.g. fieldcommand / your password).
5	Your USB printer appears in the Local Printers list. Select it and click Continue .
6	Enter a Name (e.g. FieldCommand-Printer), Description, and Location. Check Share This Printer . Click Continue .
7	Select the correct printer driver. Click Add Printer .
8	Set default options (paper size: Letter) and click Set Default Options .
9	Click Print Test Page to confirm the printer is working.

B.3 Add the Shared Printer on Operator Devices

DEVICE TYPE	HOW TO ADD THE SHARED PRINTER
Windows laptop (Winlink / JS8Call station)	Settings → Bluetooth & devices → Printers & scanners → Add a printer or scanner. Windows discovers the CUPS shared printer automatically on EMCOMM-NET via Bonjour. Select FieldCommand-Printer when it appears and click Add device.
Mac / macOS	System Settings → Printers & Scanners → click + (Add Printer). Click the Default tab — the shared printer appears via Bonjour discovery. Select it and click Add.
iPad / iPhone (AirPrint)	No setup required. CUPS + Avahi advertises the printer as AirPrint-compatible. Open any FieldCommand page → tap the Share icon → tap Print → select the printer. Works on any iOS device on EMCOMM-NET.
Android tablet / phone	Install the free CUPS Print app from Google Play. Open the app → Add Printer → enter IP 192.168.50.1, Port 631, Protocol IPP. The printer appears in the Android print dialog for all apps.

DEVICE TYPE	HOW TO ADD THE SHARED PRINTER
Chromebook	Settings → Advanced → Printing → Printers → Add Printer. Enter: Name = FieldCommand-Printer, Address = 192.168.50.1, Protocol = IPP, Queue = /printers/FieldCommand-Printer. Click Add.
Raspberry Pi 500 / 500+ (operator workstation)	Chromium browser (pre-installed): the CUPS printer appears automatically in the print dialog. No additional setup needed — Chromium on Pi OS discovers CUPS printers via Bonjour. For Firefox ESR on the Pi 500: install via <code>sudo apt install firefox-esr</code> then open Print → More Settings → select the printer from the destination list. Alternatively, run: <code>sudo usermod -aG lpadmin fieldcommand</code> to give the Pi 500 user full access to the CUPS admin at http://192.168.50.1:631 .

B.4 Recommended Printers for Field Use

Monochrome Laser (recommended for most EOC deployments)

PRINTER	CONNECTION	WHY IT WORKS WELL
Brother HL-L2350DW	USB or Wi-Fi	Excellent Linux driver support out of the box. Fast, compact, duplex, durable. Best all-round choice for field EOC use. Under \$130.
HP LaserJet Pro M15w / P1102w	USB or Wi-Fi	Full Linux support via HP HPLIP driver (installed automatically with CUPS). Fast, reliable, very low cost per page. Under \$150.

Color Multifunction Laser (ICS maps, colored forms, and chart printing)

PRINTER	CONNECTION	WHY IT WORKS WELL
Brother MFC-L3770CDW	USB, Wi-Fi, or Ethernet	Color laser all-in-one with duplex, scan, copy, fax. Full Linux support via Brother driver. Prints color ICS maps and resource boards clearly. Under \$400.
HP Color LaserJet Pro MFP M479fdw	USB, Wi-Fi, or Ethernet	Color laser multifunction — print, scan, copy, fax. HPLIP driver works with CUPS out of the box. Excellent for IAP packages with color-coded sections. Under \$500.
Canon imageCLASS MF743Cdw	USB, Wi-Fi, or Ethernet	Color laser multifunction with excellent Linux CUPS driver (CAPT driver). Handles letter and legal paper. Good choice for permanent EOC installations. Under \$450.

Portable / Battery-Powered (mobile and field deployments without shore power)

PRINTER	CONNECTION	WHY IT WORKS WELL
Canon PIXMA TR150	USB or Wi-Fi (battery built-in)	Compact inkjet with rechargeable battery. Prints ~200 pages per charge. Letter size. Wi-Fi connects directly to EMCOMM-NET. Under \$200.
HP OfficeJet 200	USB or Wi-Fi (battery optional)	Portable inkjet with larger paper tray than TR150. Optional battery accessory. Good for shelter check-in stations and mobile command posts. Under \$180.

Option C — Network Printer on EMCOMM-NET (Simplest Shared Setup)

A Wi-Fi or Ethernet printer is connected directly to the ASUS router or UniFi switch — no Pi involvement required at all. All devices on EMCOMM-NET can discover and print to it automatically via Bonjour / mDNS. This works with any network-capable printer including color multifunction laser printers that have built-in Wi-Fi or Ethernet. This is the simplest option for permanent EOC installations where a color MFP is already on site.

Option C works with any network-capable printer — including all three color multifunction laser printers listed in the BOM. These are the best choice for a permanent EOC installation because they connect directly to EMCOMM-NET with no Pi configuration, provide color printing for ICS maps and IAP packages, and are discoverable by every device on scene automatically.

CONNECTION METHOD	COMPATIBLE PRINTERS	HOW TO SET UP
Wi-Fi (wireless)	Brother MFC-L3770CDW / HP Color LaserJet M479fdw / Canon MF743Cdw / Canon PIXMA TR150 / HP OfficeJet 200	Use the printer control panel to join EMCOMM-NET. Enter the Wi-Fi password when prompted. The printer receives a 192.168.50.x address from the ASUS router automatically. All EMCOMM-NET devices discover it via Bonjour — no driver installation needed.
Ethernet (wired)	Brother MFC-L3770CDW / HP Color LaserJet M479fdw / Canon MF743Cdw	Run a CAT 6 cable from the printer Ethernet port to any spare UniFi Switch port (Ports 3 through 5). The printer receives an IP automatically. Set a static DHCP reservation in the ASUS router so the IP never changes between activations.

Reserve a Static IP for the Printer (Recommended)

```
# On the ASUS router web UI (http://192.168.50.1):
# LAN → DHCP Server → Manually Assigned IP
# Enter the printer MAC address → assign a fixed IP, e.g.: 192.168.50.10
# Reboot the printer to pick up the reservation
# Confirm: ping 192.168.50.10
```

Printer Option Comparison

	Option A — Client Printer	Option B — USB via Pi / CUPS	Option C — Network Printer
Pi configuration needed	None	CUPS (auto-installed)	None
One printer for all operators	Each device needs own printer	Shared across EMCOMM-NET	Shared across EMCOMM-NET
Works without internet	Yes	Yes	Yes
iOS / AirPrint support	Requires AirPrint printer	Yes via CUPS + Avahi	Yes if AirPrint printer
Battery printer support	Yes	Yes (USB connected)	Yes (Wi-Fi connected)
Best for	Single operator or tablet with own printer	Any USB printer, shared to all devices	Wi-Fi/Ethernet printer already on site

For most your callsign field activations, Option B (USB printer via CUPS) is recommended. A Brother HL-L2350DW or HP LaserJet plugged into the Pi USB hub covers all ICS forms, net logs, and cheat sheets needed for a typical activation.

8 First Boot Verification — Full System

Step 8: First Boot Verification

After the installer completes and the Pi reboots, run through this verification checklist before handing off the system. Every service should show "active" and the dashboard should load cleanly from another device on EMCOMM-NET. If anything is not running, the troubleshooting section at the end of this guide covers the most common issues and their fixes.

```
# Check all FieldCommand services
for svc in fcc-lookup health-monitor deadmans ics-platform kiwix nginx pat; do
echo "$svc: $(systemctl is-active $svc)"
done

# Test the dashboard from the Pi itself
curl -s http://localhost/ | head -5
# Test API endpoints
curl http://localhost:5050/health # FCC API health check
curl http://localhost:5051/health # System health monitor
# Verify Pi has the correct static IP
ip addr show eth0
# Should show: inet 192.168.50.1/24
```

Pre-Deployment Data Checklist

Before every activation, load the following data into FieldCommand. This can be done days ahead or immediately on-site — all data is stored locally and persists through reboots. The Preflight page (<http://192.168.50.1/preflight.html>) automatically verifies each of these items when it loads.

DATA	HOW TO LOAD	WHERE TO VERIFY	IMPACT IF MISSING
Organization setup	http://192.168.50.1/setup.html → enter org name, callsign, contact information, and deployment location.	Preflight → Data Readiness → Organization Setup shows ✓	ICS forms, cover pages, and header blocks will show blank fields
FCC Amateur Database	Installed automatically by install.sh. Refresh: <code>sudo systemctl start fcc-refresh.service</code> (runs in background, ~10 minutes, ~600 MB download).	Preflight → Data Readiness → FCC Callsign Database shows record count and age	Net logger callsign lookup and AMPRNet authentication will not work
Member Roster	http://192.168.50.1/roster.html → Import CSV or + Add Member. CSV columns: first_name, last_name, callsign, radio_id, ema_id, city, state.	Preflight → Data Readiness → Member Roster shows member count	Check-in forms will not auto-populate names; EMA ID lookup will not work
Repeater Database	http://192.168.50.1/repeaters.html → Offline File tab → log in at repeaterbook.com (free account) → search area → Export → CSV → drag CSV onto the drop zone. RepeaterBook CSV includes GPS coordinates.	Preflight → Data Readiness → Repeater Database shows count and how many have coordinates	ICS-205 channel picker will be empty; repeater map overlay will show no pins

DATA	HOW TO LOAD	WHERE TO VERIFY	IMPACT IF MISSING
Channel Library	http://192.168.50.1/channel_library.html → + Add Channel, or click "+ Add to Channel Library" from the Repeater Database map popup.	Preflight → Data Readiness → Channel Library shows channel count	ICS-205 communications plan will have no channels to select
Active Incident	http://192.168.50.1/incident.html → + New Incident → enter incident name, type, location, and start time → Save. Or activate an event template at event_templates.html .	Preflight → Data Readiness → Active Incident shows ✓	Net logger, resource board, ICS forms, and T-cards will have no incident to attach to

The Preflight Deployment Checklist at <http://192.168.50.1/preflight.html> auto-checks all six items above on page load and shows live server detail — record counts, database age, and error descriptions — without any operator input. Run the Preflight page as the final go/no-go check before activating the system. Each NO-GO item includes a direct link to the page where it can be resolved.

PART 2 — AMATEUR RADIO GROUP SETUP

Skip this entire section if no licensed amateur radio group is involved in your deployment. FieldCommand IMS operates fully and completely without any of the components in Part 2. All 49 web tools, ICS forms, net loggers, FEMA documentation, personnel accountability, and every other feature in Part 1 work independently of amateur radio hardware or services. Part 2 is for deployments where an ARES, RACES, amateur radio club, or other FCC-licensed amateur radio group is the lead or a key partner. A licensed amateur operator must lead the registration and setup for every item in this section.

PART 2 SECTION	WHAT IT INSTALLS / CONFIGURES	SKIP IF...
A — AMPRNet / 44Net Gateway	WireGuard tunnel to 44.0.0.0/8 amateur radio IP network. Dedicated gateway Pi. FCC callsign authentication.	No licensed amateur group leads the deployment
B — FCC Amateur Database	Offline SQLite database of 800K+ US amateur licensees. Enables callsign lookup in net loggers, check-in, and AMPRNet auth.	No amateur radio net logging or callsign validation needed
C — APRS Setup (Direwolf + YAAC)	APRS receive/transmit via TNC or radio interface. Direwolf software TNC + YAAC tactical display. Digirig, Signalink, or other USB TNC required.	No APRS capability needed or no TNC available
D — Pat Winlink	Winlink email-over-radio. Packet (VHF), VARA HF, VARA FM, Telnet. Callsign required. TNC or IC-7300 required for RF sessions.	No Winlink needed or no HF/VHF radio station
E — Windows Laptop (Winlink Express + JS8Call)	Winlink Express + VARA HF on Windows. JS8Call HF keyboard messaging. IC-7300 or compatible HF transceiver required.	No HF station or Windows laptop in the deployment
F — SCS PACTOR Modem	PACTOR 1/2/3/4 HF digital modem for Winlink. Highest throughput and reliability on HF. SCS PXdragon DR-9400 (current flagship, USB-C + LAN) or P4dragon DR-7400 (USB-B). PACTOR 4 on both.	No PACTOR modem or PACTOR not required for your nets

Part 2A — AMPRNet / 44Net Gateway Setup

What is AMPRNet and 44Net Connect?

AMPRNet — Amateur Packet Radio Network — is the global amateur radio IP network operating on the 44.0.0.0/8 address block, an entire Class A range permanently assigned by IANA to ARRL specifically for amateur radio use. Every licensed amateur radio operator in the world can apply for a block of 44.x.x.x IP addresses. These addresses are globally routable and reachable by any other AMPRNet participant, whether over RF (packet radio, APRS, mesh) or via an encrypted internet tunnel.

44Net Connect (connect.44net.cloud) is the current WireGuard-based tunneling service that makes AMPRNet accessible over the internet. The AMPRNet portal (portal.ampr.org) manages IP allocations and generates the WireGuard configuration for each registered operator. Once configured, the tunnel brings 44.0.0.0/8 directly to your gateway Pi — every device on EMCOMM-NET can reach any AMPRNet address worldwide as if it were a local IP address.

Is AMPRNet Right for Your Deployment?

AMPRNet is beneficial when an amateur radio group is the lead organization or a key partner in the EMCOMM-NET deployment. If FieldCommand is being deployed by or with an ARES, RACES, Amateur Radio Club, or other FCC-licensed amateur radio group, AMPRNet adds significant value: Winlink via radio-path gateways, APRS connectivity, inter-node FieldCommand communication, and access to a global amateur radio data network — all without touching the commercial internet.

If the deployment is primarily for public safety or served agency personnel without an amateur radio group involved, the AMPRNet gateway adds hardware cost and complexity with limited benefit. FieldCommand IMS runs entirely without AMPRNet — all 49 web pages, ICS forms, FEMA documentation, net loggers, personnel accountability, and all other tools operate locally on EMCOMM-NET with no dependency on AMPRNet. The 44Net Gateway Pi is an optional enhancement, not a requirement.

SCENARIO	AMPRNet RECOMMENDED?	REASON
ARES/RACES group leads the deployment	✓ Yes — strong benefit	Winlink via AMPRNet path, APRS-IS, inter-node data, global amateur station reach
Amateur radio club operates the EOC comms	✓ Yes — strong benefit	Same as above — the licensed operators can register and maintain the allocation
Amateur radio operators are supporting partners	■ Consider — moderate benefit	Beneficial if the licensed operators take ownership of the AMPRNet registration
Public safety agency only — no amateur radio group	✗ Not recommended	Requires FCC amateur license for registration. Adds complexity with limited payoff.
Municipal EOC with some licensed staff	■ Consider — if a licensed operator leads	One designated licensed operator can register under their callsign and maintain it

The Amateur Radio Group Must Lead This Process

The AMPRNet registration and maintenance process requires an FCC-licensed amateur radio operator. It cannot be done by a public safety agency, a municipality, or an IT department acting alone. The IP block is assigned to a callsign, maintained under that callsign, and all use is subject to Part 97 rules. The amateur radio group must own this — the served agency or EOC cannot.

In practical terms, this means the process should be initiated and led by the ARES Emergency Coordinator (EC), club President, or a designated technical lead who holds an FCC amateur license. The following organizational steps should happen before any hardware is purchased or any software is configured:

STEP	WHO DOES IT	WHAT HAPPENS
Designate the AMPRNet technical lead	ARES EC or club President	Identify a licensed amateur (any class) who will own the registration, maintain the allocation, and be the point of contact for AMPRNet administrators. Their callsign becomes the registered callsign for the subnet.
Coordinate with the regional AMPRNet administrator	Designated technical lead	AMPRNet is regionally administered. In Illinois, contact the Illinois AMPRNet coordinator (reachable via ARRL Illinois or the AMPRNet mailing list) to understand what address blocks are available in your area and to establish a relationship before submitting the formal request.
Agree on the subnet size and naming	Technical lead + club leadership	A /29 gives 6 usable addresses (enough for one FieldCommand deployment plus growth). A /28 gives 14 addresses (suitable for multiple fixed and portable stations). The technical lead proposes this in the registration justification.
Establish a club or group callsign if needed	Club leadership	The allocation can be under a personal callsign (e.g. KE4CON) or a club callsign (e.g. K9ESV). A club callsign is preferable for organizational deployments — it survives individual license changes and transfers more easily.
Plan for long-term maintenance	Club leadership + technical lead	AMPRNet allocations are permanent but require the license to remain active and the portal account to be maintained. Identify a backup technical lead in case the primary moves or is unavailable at activation time.

What AMPRNet Enables — Capabilities and Restrictions

CAPABILITY	DESCRIPTION	REQUIRES WAN?
Winlink via AMPRNet path	Connect to Winlink RMS gateways that have 44.x.x.x addresses. Keeps Winlink traffic within the amateur radio network rather than the commercial internet. Useful when you want to avoid commercial internet dependency for message handling.	Yes — WireGuard tunnel requires internet to establish, but once up, Winlink sessions travel over the 44-net tunnel
APRS-IS via AMPRNet	APRS-IS network servers are reachable on 44.x.x.x addresses. Configure Direwolf or YAAC to use the AMPRNet path instead of the public internet.	Yes — same tunnel dependency
Inter-node FieldCommand	Two FieldCommand systems with 44Net gateways can share net log data, resource board status, and incident information over AMPRNet without routing through the commercial internet. Useful for multi-site EOC deployments.	Yes — tunnel required
Direct 44.x.x.x station access	Any amateur station worldwide reachable on 44.x.x.x — whether via RF packet, mesh networking, or WireGuard — is directly addressable from any EMCOMM-NET device.	Yes — tunnel required
Static globally routable IP addresses	Your 44.x.x.x block is permanently yours and globally routable. Other AMPRNet participants can reach your stations at a fixed address that never changes, regardless of your ISP or location.	No — addresses are permanent; reachability requires tunnel

Part 97 restrictions apply to all AMPRNet traffic: No encryption of content (WireGuard tunnel encryption of transport is permitted). No commercial traffic. Station identification required. No third-party traffic unless authorized. AMPRNet is a tool for the amateur radio community — public safety agencies using it through an amateur radio group must ensure all traffic complies with Part 97.

How to Get Your AMPRNet IP Allocation — Overview

The process is straightforward but not fast. Allow **2–6 weeks** from initial registration to receiving a confirmed allocation. Regional administrators are volunteers and response times vary. Start this process well before your planned activation date.

PHASE	ACTION	TIMELINE
1 — Coordinate locally	Contact your regional AMPRNet coordinator before registering. Ask what blocks are available in your area, introduce your organization, and confirm they are aware of the incoming request. Illinois: check ARRL Illinois Section or the AMPRNet-Illinois mailing list.	1–2 days
2 — Create portal account	Go to https://portal.ampr.org and register. Use your FCC callsign as your username. The portal verifies your license automatically against the FCC ULS database.	1 day
3 — Request subnet	Log in → Subnets → Request Subnet. Select your region. Request a /29 (6 addresses) or /28 (14 addresses). In the justification field, describe your organization, your role in EMCOMM, the number of fixed and portable stations, and intended use. A clear, detailed justification speeds approval.	1 day to submit
4 — Wait for approval	The regional AMPRNet administrator reviews your request and may contact you with questions. Once approved, your allocation appears in portal.ampr.org → Subnets → My Subnets with status Active.	1–6 weeks

PHASE	ACTION	TIMELINE
5 — Download WireGuard config	After approval, the portal generates a WireGuard configuration specific to your subnet. Download it — it contains your private key, your 44.x.x.x address, and the connect.44net.cloud endpoint details. Store this securely — it is the credential for your tunnel.	Immediate after approval
6 — Configure gateway Pi	Follow Part B of this installation guide to configure the gateway Pi with the WireGuard config from the portal.	1–2 hours

Keep a printed copy of your portal login, assigned subnet, and WireGuard configuration in your FieldCommand go-kit. If the gateway Pi needs to be rebuilt at a future activation, you will need these credentials. The portal generates a new WireGuard private key if needed — store the portal login credentials, not just the key file.

AMPRNet in FieldCommand — What the Software Does

The following files are part of FieldCommand and work together to provide integrated 44Net gateway support across both Pis:

FILE	RUNS ON	PURPOSE
scripts/setup_44net.sh	Gateway Pi (192.168.50.2)	Installer for the gateway Pi. Sets up WireGuard, static IP, IP forwarding, status service, and Desktop autostart. Run once on the gateway Pi.
python/amprgate_status.py	Gateway Pi (192.168.50.2)	Flask status service on port 9000. Serves the gateway dashboard UI and /api/status JSON endpoint. Installed by setup_44net.sh.
systemd/amprgate-status.service	Gateway Pi (192.168.50.2)	Systemd unit that keeps amprgate_status.py running. Installed by setup_44net.sh. Starts after wg-quick@ampr0.
python/amprgate_poll.py	FieldCommand Pi (192.168.50.1)	Polls the gateway Pi every 30 seconds and writes status to /opt/fieldcommand/data/amprgate_status.json for the dashboard.
systemd/amprgate-poll.service	FieldCommand Pi (192.168.50.1)	Systemd unit for the poll service. Installed automatically by the FieldCommand install.sh.
html/amprgate.html	FieldCommand Pi (192.168.50.1)	Dashboard page at http://192.168.50.1/amprgate.html. Shows tunnel state, AMPRNet address, traffic stats, and tunnel controls.

AMPRNet (Amateur Packet Radio Network) is the global amateur radio IP network using the reserved 44.0.0.0/8 address block assigned by IANA to ARRL. It provides licensed amateur radio operators with globally routable IP addresses reachable over RF links or via encrypted internet tunnels to the AMPRNet gateway. Adding a dedicated 44Net gateway Pi to FieldCommand gives every device on EMCOMM-NET full access to the AMPRNet — Winlink gateways, APRS-IS servers, Mesh networking nodes, and other amateur stations worldwide that are reachable on 44.x.x.x addresses.

The 44Net Gateway Pi is completely separate from the FieldCommand server Pi. It runs WireGuard, ip routing, and a status page only. If the gateway goes down or needs reconfiguring, FieldCommand continues operating normally. This isolation was an intentional design choice — keep routing infrastructure separate from the communications server.

Part A — Get Your AMPRNet Allocation (Do This First — Allow 2-4 Weeks)

Before configuring any software, you need an AMPRNet IP address block assigned to your callsign. This is a one-time registration process managed by the AMPRNet administrators at ampr.org. The block you receive will be something like 44.x.x.x/29 (6 usable addresses) or 44.x.x.x/28 (14 usable addresses) depending on what is available in your region.

STEP	ACTION
1	Create an account at portal.ampr.org — go to https://portal.ampr.org and click Register. You must use your callsign your callsign as your username. Verify your license via the FCC ULS lookup that the portal performs automatically.

2	Request a subnet allocation — after logging in, click Subnets → Request Subnet. Select your region (Illinois — typically 44.24.x.x or 44.172.x.x range). Request a /29 block for a small deployment or a /28 if you anticipate growth. In the justification field, explain the your organization EMCOMM-NET deployment and intended use.
3	Coordinate with your regional AMPRNet administrator — Illinois AMPRNet administration is coordinated through ARRL. You may be contacted by the regional admin for verification. Response times vary from days to several weeks. Be patient.
4	Receive your allocation — you will get an email with your assigned 44.x.x.x/29 block. The portal will also show your allocation under Subnets → My Subnets. Record this allocation — you will need it in Part B.
5	Note your WireGuard endpoint credentials — the portal provides a WireGuard configuration for your specific subnet. Download or copy this — it contains your private key, allowed IPs, and the amprgw.ampr.org endpoint address.

ARRL membership is not required for an AMPRNet allocation, but a valid FCC amateur radio license (any class) is required. The your club or personal callsign is valid for this purpose. The allocation is tied to the callsign and is permanent as long as the license remains active.

Part B — Set Up the 44Net Gateway Pi

Once you have your AMPRNet allocation, the following steps configure the dedicated gateway Pi running in the Argon NEO 5 case. This Pi should be freshly flashed with Raspberry Pi OS Lite (64-bit). It does not need the FieldCommand installer — it runs WireGuard and routing only.

B.1 Initial OS Setup

Flash Raspberry Pi OS Desktop (64-bit) to the M.2 SATA SSD using Raspberry Pi Imager. Desktop is used on the gateway Pi so any team member can check tunnel status from the local keyboard and monitor without SSH. Chromium opens the status page automatically on login. During Imager advanced options set:

OPTION	VALUE
Hostname	amprgate.local — discoverable as amprgate.local on EMCOMM-NET
Username	amprgate — used by the gateway setup script
Password	Choose a strong password and record it with the FieldCommand credentials
Enable SSH	Yes — useful for remote diagnostics if the monitor is not available
Wi-Fi	Your home or lab Wi-Fi for initial package downloads — switched to wired EMCOMM-NET after setup
Locale	US/Central — matches the FieldCommand Pi for consistent log timestamps

B.2 Assign Static IP and Install WireGuard

```
# SSH into the gateway Pi
ssh amprgate@[current-pi-ip]

# Update packages
sudo apt-get update && sudo apt-get full-upgrade -y

# Install WireGuard
sudo apt-get install -y wireguard wireguard-tools

# Set static IP on eth0
sudo nmcli con mod "Wired connection 1", ipv4.addresses 192.168.50.2/24, ipv4.gateway 192.168.50.254,
ipv4.dns "8.8.8.8 8.8.4.4", ipv4.method manual
sudo nmcli con up "Wired connection 1"

# Verify
ip addr show eth0
# Expected: inet 192.168.50.2/24
```

B.3 Configure the WireGuard Tunnel

The AMPRNet portal provides a WireGuard configuration specific to your subnet. The following is the general structure — replace the placeholder values with the actual values from your portal allocation.

```
# Create the WireGuard config directory
sudo mkdir -p /etc/wireguard
sudo chmod 700 /etc/wireguard

# Create the tunnel config file
sudo nano /etc/wireguard/ampr0.conf

# Paste the following – replace ALL values in [brackets] with your portal values:
[Interface]
PrivateKey = [your-private-key-from-portal]
Address = [your-44.x.x.x/29-address]
ListenPort = 51820
PostUp = ip route add 44.0.0.0/8 dev ampr0
PostUp = iptables -A FORWARD -i ampr0 -j ACCEPT
PostUp = iptables -A FORWARD -o ampr0 -j ACCEPT
PostUp = iptables -t nat -A POSTROUTING -o eth0 -j MASQUERADE
PostDown = ip route del 44.0.0.0/8 dev ampr0
PostDown = iptables -D FORWARD -i ampr0 -j ACCEPT
PostDown = iptables -D FORWARD -o ampr0 -j ACCEPT
PostDown = iptables -t nat -D POSTROUTING -o eth0 -j MASQUERADE

[Peer]
PublicKey = [amprnet-gateway-public-key-from-portal]
Endpoint = amprgw.ampr.org:51820
AllowedIPs = 44.0.0.0/8
PersistentKeepalive = 25
```

B.4 Enable IP Forwarding and Start the Tunnel

```
# Enable IP forwarding (required for routing between EMCOMM-NET and AMPRNet)
echo "net.ipv4.ip_forward = 1" | sudo tee -a /etc/sysctl.conf
sudo sysctl -p

# Start the WireGuard tunnel
sudo wg-quick up ampr0

# Enable at boot
sudo systemctl enable wg-quick@ampr0

# Check tunnel status
sudo wg show ampr0
# Expected: shows latest handshake, transfer stats, allowed IPs

# Test reachability into AMPRNet
ping 44.0.0.1 -c 4
# Expected: replies from 44.0.0.1 (AMPRNet gateway)
```

B.5 Access Control — Who Can Reach What

FieldCommand restricts access to the 44Net gateway on two levels. This is both a security measure and a Part 97 compliance measure — only licensed amateur radio operators should be able to view or control the AMPRNet gateway.

PORT	ACCESSIBLE FROM	AUTH REQUIRED	PROVIDES
Port 9000 (0.0.0.0)	Any EMCOMM-NET device (192.168.50.x)	None for /api/status (machine poll). Valid FCC callsign for web UI.	Read-only status JSON. Callsign-authenticated web dashboard.
Port 9001 (127.0.0.1)	Gateway Pi keyboard only (localhost — not reachable from network)	Valid callsign session from port 9000 login. Physical presence required.	Tunnel control: up / down / restart.

Tunnel controls (up/down/restart) are intentionally inaccessible from the network. An operator who wants to restart the WireGuard tunnel must sit at the gateway Pi keyboard, open Chromium, log in with their FCC callsign, and use the local control interface. This prevents accidental or unauthorized tunnel disruption from operator laptops or phones. The FieldCommand Pi polling service reads /api/status on port 9000 without authentication — this is a read-only machine-to-machine call and is intentional.

B.5 Advertise the 44Net Route to EMCOMM-NET Devices

For other devices on EMCOMM-NET to use the 44Net gateway automatically, the ASUS router needs to push a static route to all DHCP clients. This tells every device: "to reach anything in 44.0.0.0/8, use 192.168.50.2".

STEP	ACTION
1	Open the ASUS router admin at http://192.168.50.254 .
2	Go to LAN → Route .
3	Click Add and enter: Network/Host IP = 44.0.0.0 , Netmask = 255.0.0.0 , Gateway = 192.168.50.2 , Interface = LAN .
4	Click Apply .
5	On any EMCOMM-NET device, verify the route was received:


```
# On any EMCOMM-NET device (Pi 500, Windows laptop, etc.)
ip route show | grep 44
# Expected: 44.0.0.0/8 via 192.168.50.2 dev eth0

# Windows equivalent (Command Prompt)
route print | find "44."
# Expected: 44.0.0.0 0.0.0.0 192.168.50.2 ...

# Test from the FieldCommand Pi
ping 44.0.0.1 -c 4
# If reachable, FieldCommand can now connect to AMPRNet resources
```

B.6 Gateway Status Page

Install a lightweight status page on the 44Net Pi so operators can verify the tunnel state from any EMCOMM-NET browser without SSH access. This is a small Flask application that displays tunnel status, connected peers, and recent handshake times.

```

# Install Python and Flask on the 44Net Pi
sudo apt-get install -y python3 python3-pip python3-venv
python3 -m venv /opt/amprgate/venv
/opt/amprgate/venv/bin/pip install flask

# Create the status app
sudo mkdir -p /opt/amprgate
sudo nano /opt/amprgate/status.py

# Paste the following into status.py:
# ---
from flask import Flask, jsonify
import subprocess, json
app = Flask(__name__)

@app.route("/")
def index():
    return open("/opt/amprgate/status.html").read()

@app.route("/api/status")
def status():
    wg = subprocess.run(["sudo", "wg", "show", "ampr0", "dump"],
        capture_output=True, text=True).stdout
    lines = [l.split(" ") for l in wg.strip().split(" ") if l]
    return jsonify({"tunnel": "up" if lines else "down", "peers": len(lines)-1})

if __name__ == "__main__":
    app.run(host="0.0.0.0", port=9000)
# ---

# Create systemd service
sudo nano /etc/systemd/system/amprgate-status.service
# Paste:
[Unit]
Description=AMPRNet Gateway Status Page
After=network.target wg-quick@ampr0.service

[Service]
User=amprgate
ExecStart=/opt/amprgate/venv/bin/python /opt/amprgate/status.py
Restart=always

[Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target

sudo systemctl enable --now amprgate-status
# Status page now at: http://192.168.50.2:9000

```

Part C — What You Can Do on AMPRNet

Once the gateway is operational and the route is advertised to EMCOMM-NET, every device on EMCOMM-NET has full access to the AMPRNet. Here are the most useful applications for your organization operations:

HOW IT USES 44NET	ACCESS FROM EMCOMM-NET
Some Winlink RMS gateways have 44.x.x.x addresses. Pat Winlink on the FieldCommand Pi can connect to them directly over the AMPRNet tunnel rather than the commercial internet — useful when only amateur radio paths are available.	Pat Winlink at http://192.168.50.1:8090 Add AMPRNet RMS
The APRS-IS network has servers reachable on 44.x.x.x. Direwolf and YAAC can connect to APRS-IS via the AMPRNet path, keeping APRS traffic within the amateur radio network.	Configure APRS-IS server address in Direwolf or YAAC set
If another your organization station runs a second FieldCommand system with its own 44Net gateway, the two systems can share net data and resource boards over AMPRNet without routing traffic through the commercial internet.	Future capability — requires second FieldCommand deploy
Some VoIP amateur radio nodes are reachable on 44.x.x.x addresses, providing RF-to-AMPRNet linking without commercial internet dependency.	Direct connection to 44.x.x.x node addresses
Any amateur station worldwide with a 44.x.x.x address (whether via RF packet or WireGuard tunnel) is directly reachable from any EMCOMM-NET device for data exchange, file transfer, or status checking.	Direct TCP/IP connections to 44.x.x.x addresses

AMPRNet does not carry voice traffic and is not a replacement for your radio links. It is a data network for IP-based amateur radio applications. All traffic on AMPRNet is subject to Part 97 rules — no encryption of content, no commercial traffic, licensed operator identification required. WireGuard encryption of the tunnel itself is permitted as it is the transport, not the content.

Part D — Verification Checklist

CHECK	COMMAND / METHOD	EXPECTED RESULT
AMPRNet portal shows allocation	Login to portal.ampr.org → Subnets → My Subnets	Your 44.x.x.x/29 block shows Status: Active
WireGuard tunnel is up on gateway Pi	SSH to 192.168.50.2 then: sudo wg show ampr0	Shows latest handshake within last 2 minutes
AMPRNet gateway reachable from gateway Pi	ping 44.0.0.1 -c 4	Replies received — round trip time typically 10-50 ms
EMCOMM-NET devices have 44 route	ip route show grep 44 (on any EMCOMM-NET device)	44.0.0.0/8 via 192.168.50.2
AMPRNet reachable from FieldCommand Pi	ping 44.0.0.1 -c 4 (on FieldCommand Pi)	Replies received
Status page accessible	Open http://192.168.50.2:9000 in any browser on EMCOMM-NET	Shows callsign login page — enter a valid FCC callsign to proceed
Callsign login works	Enter your callsign at http://192.168.50.2:9000 login page	FCC database validates callsign — dashboard loads showing tunnel status
Access log recording	SSH to gateway Pi: tail /var/log/amprgate-access.log	Shows LOGIN-OK entry with your callsign, IP, and license class

CHECK	COMMAND / METHOD	EXPECTED RESULT
Tunnel control blocked from network	From a laptop on EMCOMM-NET: curl http://192.168.50.2:9001	Connection refused — port 9001 is localhost-only
AMPRNet reachable from Pi 500 workstation	Open http://192.168.50.2:9000 in Chromium on Pi 500	Status page loads and shows tunnel UP

B**FCC Amateur Database (Part 2B)**

Part 2B — FCC Amateur Database

The FCC database gives FieldCommand instant offline access to the entire US amateur radio license database — approximately 800,000 active licensees. When a net control operator types a callsign into the check-in field, FieldCommand looks up the licensee name, license class, and address automatically in under a millisecond, with no internet connection required. This is one of the most-used features during ARES/RACES net operations.

The installer offers to download and build the database during Step 4 (answer Y). If you skipped it during installation, or if the database needs to be rebuilt, run the commands below. Building takes approximately 5 to 10 minutes on a Pi 5 and requires an active internet connection.

```
# If you selected "y" during install, it already ran.
# To build or rebuild manually:
sudo -u fieldcommand \
/opt/fieldcommand/venv/bin/python \
/opt/fieldcommand/python/build_fcc_db.py
# Automatic weekly refresh timer:
sudo systemctl status fcc-refresh.timer
# Force immediate refresh:
sudo systemctl start fcc-refresh.service
```

C

APRS Setup — Direwolf TNC + YAAC (Part 2C)

Part 2C — APRS Setup (Direwolf TNC + YAAC)

Direwolf is the software TNC that decodes APRS off the radio. It exposes a KISS interface (TCP port 8001) and an AGWPE interface (TCP port 8000) — but it has NO web or REST interface of its own. Live stations reach the Tactical APRS Map from APRS Command (on the Windows laptop), which connects to Direwolf and serves the map its station feed; a small Pi-side KISS bridge can serve the same feed if you want the map to work without the laptop. YAAC (port 8082) is an optional on-Pi APRS client.

APRS is entirely optional. FieldCommand runs fully without it — you simply will not see live APRS stations on the tactical map. If you are not planning to use a TNC or radio interface, skip this step entirely and proceed to Step 8 (Printer Setup).

The FieldCommand installer installs Direwolf (via apt) and YAAC automatically, writes a starter `/etc/direwolf.conf`, and enables `direwolf.service`. If the installer succeeded, you only need to edit the config (Section 9.3).

9.1 Verify Automatic Installation

```
# Direwolf — software TNC (no jar; installed via apt)
which direwolf && direwolf -h | head -1
sudo systemctl status direwolf
# YAAC — optional Java client
java -version
ls -lh /opt/yaac/YAAC.jar
sudo systemctl status yaac
```

9.2 Manual Install — If Automatic Install Failed

```
# Direwolf — software TNC
sudo apt install -y direwolf
sudo systemctl enable --now direwolf
# YAAC (optional) — needs Java
sudo apt install -y default-jre
sudo mkdir -p /opt/yaac
cd /tmp && wget http://www.ka2ddo.org/ka2ddo/YAAC.zip
sudo unzip YAAC.zip "*.jar" -d /opt/yaac/
sudo mv /opt/yaac/YAAC*.jar /opt/yaac/YAAC.jar 2>/dev/null || true
sudo chown -R fieldcommand:fieldcommand /opt/yaac
sudo systemctl enable --now yaac
```

9.3 Configure Direwolf (Required — First Run)

STEP	ACTION
1	Find your audio interface: <code>arecord -l</code> (note the card,device numbers).
2	Edit <code>sudo nano /etc/direwolf.conf</code> : set ADEVICE (e.g. <code>plughw:1,0</code>) and MYCALL (your callsign-SSID).
3	Restart: <code>sudo systemctl restart direwolf</code> .
4	Direwolf is receive-only by default. To transmit (iGate / digipeat), configure PTT in the config (GPIO / CM108 / rig control).

9.4 Feed the Map — APRS Command or a KISS Bridge

Direwolf itself does not serve the map. Point the map (Tactical → Settings → APRS Sources) at whatever reads Direwolf's KISS/AGW output and serves stations:

SOURCE	CONNECTS TO DIREWOLF VIA	MAP SETTING
APRS Command (Windows laptop)	KISS TCP :8001 or AGW :8000 over EMCOMM-NET	RF source host = laptop IP
Pi-side KISS bridge (optional)	KISS TCP localhost:8001	RF source host = localhost
APRS-IS internet (if WAN up)	internet APRS-IS	enable the APRS-IS layer on the map

9.5 Verify APRS is Working

```
# Watch Direwolf decode frames off the radio:
journalctl -u direwolf -f
# Confirm the KISS/AGW ports are listening (for APRS Command):
ss -tlnp | grep -E "8000|8001"
# Stations appear on the Tactical Map once APRS Command (or the bridge) is running.
```

Part 2D — Pat Winlink — Verify & Configure

Pat is an open-source Winlink client that runs directly on the Pi and is accessible from any browser on EMCOMM-NET at <http://192.168.50.1:8090>. The FieldCommand installer downloads and configures Pat automatically, so this step is primarily about verifying it is running and adding your Winlink account password.

Pat serves as the backup Winlink path when the Windows laptop is unavailable, or for VHF Packet operations when a TNC is connected directly to the Pi. your organization primary Winlink operations use Winlink Express on the Windows laptop (Step 10). Pat is the fallback.

```
# Check pat.service status
sudo systemctl status pat
# If not running:
sudo systemctl start pat && sudo systemctl enable pat
# Confirm port 8090 is listening
ss -tlnp | grep 8090
# Add your Winlink password:
sudo nano /opt/fieldcommand/.config/pat/config.json
# Verify / update these fields:
# "mycall": "your callsign" ← set by installer
# "secure_login_password": "xxxxx" ← add your Winlink password
# "http_addr": "0.0.0.0:8090" ← must be 0.0.0.0 for EMCOMM-NET access
```


Part 2E — Windows Laptop Setup (Winlink Express + JS8Call)

The Windows laptop is the primary HF digital station. It runs Winlink Express and JS8Call with the IC-7300 connected via a single USB cable. Connect the laptop to EMCOMM-NET (Wi-Fi) or the UniFi switch Port 3 (wired Ethernet).

IC-7300 One-Time Radio Setup

IC-7300 MENU PATH	SETTING
SET → Connectors → CI-V Baud Rate	115200
SET → Connectors → CI-V Transceive	ON
SET → Connectors → USB Send/Keying → USB Send	RTS
SET → Connectors → MOD Input → USB MOD Level	40–50%
COMP button (speech compression)	OFF
Mode for digital operation	USB-D

Install Winlink Express + VARA HF

STEP	ACTION
1	Download Winlink Express from: winlink.org/client-software . Run installer, accept defaults.
2	On first launch: enter your callsign, Winlink password, and grid square (your county).
3	Settings → Radio Setup: Radio=IC-7300, Control Port=(check Device Manager), Baud Rate=115200, PTT via CAT=checked.
4	Settings → Sound Card: Input=USB Audio CODEC (IC-7300), Output=USB Audio CODEC (IC-7300).
5	Download and install VARA HF from: winlink.org → VARA → VARA HF Modem. Set same audio devices in VARA HF Settings.
6	Test: Open a VARA HF session in Winlink Express → connect to any Winlink RMS gateway on 40m to confirm audio and CAT control work.

Install JS8Call

STEP	ACTION
1	Download JS8Call from: js8call.com → Windows installer. Run installer, accept defaults.
2	Launch JS8Call. Open File → Settings (F2). General tab: My Call=, My Grid=.
3	Audio tab: Input=USB Audio CODEC (IC-7300), Output=USB Audio CODEC (IC-7300).
4	Radio tab: Rig=IC-7300, PTT Method=CAT, Serial Port=(same COM port as Winlink), Baud Rate=115200.
5	Reporting tab (CRITICAL): TCP Server Hostname= 0.0.0.0 (MUST change from 127.0.0.1). Enable TCP Server API=checked. TCP Server Port= 2442 . Accept TCP Requests=checked.
6	Click OK. Restart JS8Call for API settings to take effect.
7	Set VFO to 7.078 MHz (JS8 40m calling frequency). Mode → Normal.

Windows Firewall — Allow JS8Call Port 2442

1. Search "Windows Defender Firewall" → Advanced Settings
2. Inbound Rules → New Rule → Port → TCP → Specific port: 2442 → Allow → All profiles
3. Name the rule: JS8Call API

Find the Windows Laptop IP on EMCOMM-NET

```
# Run in Windows Command Prompt:
ipconfig
# Note the IPv4 Address for the EMCOMM-NET adapter (e.g. 192.168.50.105)
# Set a DHCP reservation (recommended – gives laptop a fixed IP):
# ASUS Web UI → LAN → DHCP Server → Manually Assigned IP
# Enter laptop MAC address → assign 192.168.50.2

# Configure the FieldCommand dashboard JS8Call card:
# 1. Connect to EMCOMM-NET, open http://192.168.50.1
# 2. Find the JS8Call card (purple) in Amateur Radio section
# 3. Tap/click the card
# 4. Enter the Windows laptop IP (e.g. 192.168.50.105)
# 5. Card saves IP and opens http://192.168.50.105:2442
```

SWITCHING TO...	PROCEDURE
Winlink Express (from JS8Call)	Click Disconnect in JS8Call or close it. Open VARA HF — it automatically reclaims the USB audio device. Open Winlink Express and connect normally.
JS8Call (from Winlink)	Finish any active Winlink transmission. Close VARA HF. Minimize Winlink Express. Open JS8Call and click Connect — it reclaims the COM port and audio.
Both simultaneously (two radios)	Connect a second HF radio via a separate USB audio and CAT interface. Configure JS8Call to use that radio's COM port and audio device. Both run at the same time without conflicts.

Part 2F — SCS PACTOR Modem Setup

PACTOR is a high-performance HF digital mode used extensively in Winlink operations. It provides significantly better throughput than VARA HF on marginal or noisy HF paths, and is the only mode that supports PACTOR 4 compression on Winlink. SCS (Special Communications Systems) manufactures the only PACTOR-licensed TNCs available. A PACTOR TNC connects between the IC-7300 and the Windows laptop. This step is optional — Winlink via VARA HF works well for most activations.

Supported SCS PACTOR Modems

MODEL	PACTOR LEVEL	INTERFACE	NOTES
SCS Tracker DSP TNC	PACTOR 1 / 2 / 3	USB-B (COM port)	Entry-level PACTOR TNC. Good for most Winlink operations. Also supports PACKET and ROBUST PR. ~\$250.
SCS PTC-IIIusb	PACTOR 1 / 2 / 3	USB-B (COM port)	Full-featured controller with front-panel display. Supports PACTOR, PACKET, AMTOR, RTTY. ~\$650.
SCS P4dragon DR-7400	PACTOR 1 / 2 / 3 / 4	USB-B (COM port)	Compact PACTOR 4 modem — proven platform. Good entry point to PACTOR 4. ~\$1,100. Software compatible with PTC-III template in Winlink Express.
SCS PXdragon DR-9400 (current flagship)	PACTOR 1 / 2 / 3 / 4	USB-C + LAN + Wi-Fi/BT (BTWF model)	Successor to the P4dragon series. Quad-core ARM v8 running real-time Linux. Up to 10,500 bps on PACTOR-4. Also supports Packet Radio (1k2 AFSK / 9k6 G3RUH), Robust Packet Radio, APRS beaconing, weather-fax (RX), RTTY (RX). GPS input (galvanically isolated). 1-ppm TCXO. 10 bi-color status LEDs. DR-9400 = standard; DR-9400-BTWF = includes Wi-Fi/Bluetooth dongle + license key. Software compatible with PTC-III/P4dragon apps: Winlink Express, Airmail, SafecomLink. Available at DX Engineering, WiMo, R&L; Electronics. ~\$1,400-1,600 USD.

Physical Connection

FROM	TO	CABLE / NOTE
SCS TNC — AFSK audio output	IC-7300 — ACC jack audio input or 3.5mm mic input	SCS-supplied audio cable (included with TNC)
SCS TNC — AFSK audio input	IC-7300 — ACC jack audio output or 3.5mm speaker output	SCS-supplied audio cable (included with TNC)
SCS TNC — PTT output	IC-7300 — remote jack (ACC or SEND)	SCS-supplied PTT cable (check your TNC model)
SCS TNC — USB port	Windows laptop — any USB-A port	USB-A to USB-B or USB-A to micro-USB (included with TNC)

If you are also using VARA HF via the IC-7300 USB audio: configure the PACTOR TNC to use the IC-7300 ACC jack for audio, not the USB sound card. This allows VARA (USB audio path) and PACTOR (ACC audio path) to coexist on the same radio. Never transmit both modes simultaneously.

PXdragon DR-9400 — LAN connection option: The DR-9400 includes a LAN (Ethernet) port in addition to USB-C. When connected via LAN, Winlink Express reaches the modem as a TCP device: Settings → Radio Setup → Connection type → Network/TCP. Enter the DR-9400 LAN IP (check your router DHCP table) and port 8000. This lets the laptop connect to the modem over EMCOMM-NET without a direct USB cable — useful when the laptop and modem are at different positions in the EOC. The DR-9400-BTWF model also supports Wi-Fi and Bluetooth connections.

Configure Winlink Express for PACTOR

STEP	ACTION
1	In Winlink Express, go to Settings → Radio Setup .
2	Click Add to create a new radio entry.
3	Set Template to: SCS PTC-IIx (works for all SCS PACTOR TNCs: Tracker, PTC-IIusb, P4dragon DR-7400, and PXdragon DR-9400 are all compatible with this template).
4	Set Control Port to the COM port assigned to your SCS TNC. Check Windows Device Manager → Ports (COM & LPT) to find the correct number. The TNC appears as "USB Serial Port (COM X)".
5	Set Baud Rate to 115200 .
6	Leave PTT via CAT unchecked — the TNC handles PTT directly via the ACC cable.
7	Click OK to save the radio profile.

Open a PACTOR Winlink Session

STEP	ACTION
1	In Winlink Express, click the session type dropdown and select Open Session → PACTOR Winlink .
2	The session window opens. The TNC initializes and you will see the SCS banner text in the session log.
3	Set your frequency on the IC-7300 to a known Winlink RMS gateway frequency for your region. Common 40m PACTOR frequencies: 7.038 MHz, 7.040 MHz, 7.103 MHz.
4	Click Start . Winlink Express scans for and connects to the nearest RMS gateway.
5	The PACTOR handshake completes automatically — the session connects at the highest common level (PACTOR 1 through 4) that both stations support.
6	Send and receive messages as normal. PACTOR 4 typically completes a full ICS-213 exchange in under 2 minutes on a good path.

Verify the TNC is Responding

```
# USB-B modems (Tracker, PTC-IIIusb, DR-7400):
# PuTTY → Connection type: Serial → COM port: (check Device Manager) → Speed: 115200

# PXdragon DR-9400 via USB-C:
# Same as above – DR-9400 appears as a COM port in Device Manager

# PXdragon DR-9400 via LAN:
# PuTTY → Connection type: Raw → Host: [DR-9400 LAN IP] → Port: 8000 → Open

# Type the following TNC command:
cmd
# The TNC responds with its command prompt: cmd:

# Useful TNC verification commands:
ver # shows firmware version and TNC model
status # shows current operating status
mycall YOURCALL # replace YOURCALL with your FCC callsign

# If the TNC does not respond:
# 1. Confirm the correct COM port in Device Manager
# 2. Confirm no other application has the COM port open
# 3. Try baud rate 9600 (some TNC models default lower)
```

PACTOR levels 3 and 4 require a separate Winlink license fee beyond the standard Winlink account. PACTOR 1 and 2 are available to all licensed amateur radio operators at no additional cost. The PXdragon DR-9400 and P4dragon series also support AX.25 Packet and Robust Packet Radio (RPR), accessible via KISS TCP or the DR-9400 LAN port. The DR-9400-BTWF model adds Wi-Fi/Bluetooth, enabling phone or tablet Winlink access without a laptop for portable deployments. These provide a VHF backup to the primary HF PACTOR path.

Network Architecture Reference

Full Network Topology

The EMCOMM-NET deployment uses the ASUS RT-BE58 Go as the Wi-Fi access point and DHCP server. The primary cellular modem provides WAN connectivity via a PoE Ethernet cable directly to the ASUS WAN port. satellite dish provides automatic secondary WAN failover via the ASUS USB WAN port. The UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE distributes wired connections to both Pi servers, all operator workstations, the network printer, and additional field devices. The 44Net Gateway Pi routes the 44.0.0.0/8 AMPRNet address block for all EMCOMM-NET devices via a WireGuard tunnel to amprgw.ampr.org.

DEVICE	IP ADDRESS	ROLE	CONNECTION
ASUS RT-BE58 Go	192.168.50.254 (LAN gateway)	Wi-Fi 7 AP + DHCP server + WAN gateway	WAN: site Ethernet, satellite dish, or USB tether (optional). EMCOMM-NET SSID on 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz.
UniFi Switch Lite 16 PoE	N/A (Layer 2 switch)	Wired distribution hub — 16 ports	Port 1 uplink to ASUS router. Ports 2-16 to all wired devices.
FieldCommand Pi 5 (Pironman MAX 5)	192.168.50.1 (static)	FieldCommand application server All EmComm tools and services	Wired GbE via UniFi Switch Port 2. Does not run Wi-Fi.
44Net Gateway Pi 5 (Argon NEO 5)	192.168.50.2 (static)	AMPRNet / 44Net WireGuard gateway Routes 44.0.0.0/8 for EMCOMM-NET	Wired GbE via UniFi Switch Port 3. WireGuard tunnel to amprgw.ampr.org.
Windows Laptop	192.168.50.3 (DHCP reservation)	Winlink Express + JS8Call IC-7300 HF station	Wired via Port 4 or Wi-Fi (EMCOMM-NET).
Color MFP Printer	192.168.50.10 (DHCP reservation)	Network printer shared to all devices	Wired via Port 5 or Wi-Fi (EMCOMM-NET).
Pi 500 Workstations x4	192.168.50.20-23 (DHCP reservations)	Operator browser stations	Wired via Ports 6-9 or Wi-Fi (EMCOMM-NET).
ASUS RT-BE58 Go Mesh Node 1	Managed by AiMesh	EMCOMM-NET extension (same SSID, seamless roaming)	Wired backhaul via UniFi Port 11. Extends coverage to secondary zone.
ASUS RT-BE58 Go Mesh Node 2	Managed by AiMesh	EMCOMM-NET extension (same SSID, seamless roaming)	Wired backhaul via UniFi Port 12. Extends coverage to third zone.
Field Devices (phones, tablets, laptops)	192.168.50.100-200 (DHCP)	Additional operator browsers	Wi-Fi — EMCOMM-NET — roam between primary and mesh nodes automatically.



Recommended: set the ASUS router LAN IP to 192.168.50.254 and the Pi static IP to 192.168.50.1. This keeps the FieldCommand URL clean and the router admin clearly separate at <http://192.168.50.254>.

Web Dashboard Reference

FieldCommand IMS serves 49 web pages from the Pi. All are accessible at [http://192.168.50.1/\[page\]](http://192.168.50.1/[page]). Pages marked WAN require internet for live data but load and display cached data when offline.

PAGE	URL	NOTES
Dashboard (All-Hazards ICS)	/	Main hub — 3 modes, WAN status bar, tool cards. Default entry point.
Organization Setup	/setup.html	Configure org name, callsign, grid square, time zone, SSID
Preflight Check	/preflight.html	GO/CAUTION/NO-GO readiness. Run before every activation.
Incident Management	/incident.html	Create/manage incidents, operational periods, incident type
Incident Archive/Reset	/incident_mgmt.html	Archive to USB · Restore · Hard delete · Beta/Scenario Reset
Event Templates	/event_templates.html	6 built-in templates (Shelter/SAR/HazMat/Weather/Gathering/Exercise)
General Info / ICS-201	/general_info.html	Initial incident briefing — situation summary, initial actions
ICS Platform — Overview	/ics/index.html	Five-section ICS structure navigator
ICS — Command Section	/ics/command.html	ICS-202 objectives, ICS-208 safety, staff roster, position checklists
ICS — Operations Section	/ics/operations.html	T-card board, resource status, assignment, T-card personnel roster
ICS — Planning Section	/ics/planning.html	IAP assembly, ICS-205/206/209/211/221 forms, Planning P cycle
ICS — Logistics Section	/ics/logistics.html	ICS-205 comms (COML), ICS-206 medical (MEDL), channel library
ICS — Finance/Admin	/ics/finance.html	FEMA PA cost tracking, ICS-214 log, expenditure summary
Planning P Cycle Guide	/ics/planningp.html	15-phase IAP cycle with agenda, required forms, attendees per phase
T-Card Resource Board	/resources.html	Add/status/assign resources. T-card personnel roster per card.
NIMS Resource Types	/resource_types.html	Pre-loaded NIMS types + custom types. Available in T-card board.
GPS Resource Map	/resource_map.html	Live GPS pins per T-card — 3 placement methods, auto-refresh 30s
Starcom Resource Map	/resmap.html	Public safety unit positioning map with zone drawing tools
ICS-213 General Message	/ics213.html	Formal message with digital signature, print, Winlink export
ICS-214 Activity Log	/ics214.html	Unit activity log — export hours directly to FEMA labor costs
ICS-309 Comms Log	/ics309.html	Manual communications log with incident archiving
ICS-204A Briefing Sheet	/briefing_204a.html	Assignment briefing for branch/division supervisors
ICS Form Suite	/ics-form.html	Full ICS form set: ICS-202 through ICS-221 with digital signatures
IAP Assembly	/iap.html	IAP tracker — all forms for active incident with completion status
IAP Compile (PDF)	/iap_compile.html	One-click IAP PDF: title page + section dividers + all forms
FEMA PA Cost Documentation	/fema_costs.html	Force Account Labor, Equipment, Materials, Contracts, PW export

PAGE	URL	NOTES
FEMA Equipment Rates	/fema_rates.html	44 FEMA equipment categories — edit rates, track rate year
Cost Dashboard	/cost_dashboard.html	Live cost totals by category, burn rate, budget tracker, by period
Personnel Accountability	/accountability.html	PAR board — ICS-211, T-card personnel, Unaccounted, Cross-Reference
ICS-211 Check-In	/checkin.html	Manual ICS-211 check-in form with active list and Check Out buttons
QR/Barcode Scan Check-In	/scan_checkin.html	Camera scan or manual ID fallback. BarcodeDetector API, no library.
Member Roster	/roster.html	Directory with certs, equipment, QR code generation, CSV import/export
Amateur Net Control Logger	/netcontrol.html	Multi-net, FCC autofill, check-in/out, traffic, ICS-309, observer link
Public Safety Net Logger	/starcom.html	Radio ID check-in, Starcom/P25 nets, ICS-309 export
Net Observer Mode	/observer.html	Read-only net view, auto-refresh 15s. Share URL with EOC.
Dead Man's Switch	/deadmans.html	Audible alert if net goes silent beyond configured interval
Tactical APRS Map	/tactical.html	Leaflet — RF APRS always, APRS-IS when WAN up, SARTopo overlay
SARTopo GeoJSON Import	/sartopo_import.html	Import planning overlays from SARTopo — persists on tactical map
NEXRAD Radar	/radar.html	WAN REQUIRED. Animated NEXRAD loop — play/pause/scrub/speed/palette
NWS/HF Propagation	/propagation.html	WAN: SFI, K-index, A-index from NOAA SWPC. Band-by-band conditions.
FCC Callsign Lookup	/callsign.html	Offline — 800K+ US licensees in local SQLite. Instant results.
NTS Radiogram Generator	/nts.html	ARRL-format traffic with auto word count. Print or log.
Winlink Form Import	/winlink-import.html	Import Winlink Express XML forms into incident archive
AMPRNet Gateway Status	/amprgate.html	44Net WireGuard tunnel status, callsign auth, Part 97 access log
WAN Status Detail	/wan-status.html	Both WAN sources, detection method, last check, event log
WAN Settings	/wan_settings.html	Configure WAN sources: role, type, detection method, enable/disable
Hospital Directory	/hospitals.html	Trauma level, helipad, phone. Feeds ICS-206 medical plan.
Facilities Directory	/facilities.html	ICP, staging, shelters, supply depots. Links to T-card assignments.
Repeater Database	/repeaters.html	Filter by band/mode/CTCSS. Feeds ICS-205 channel picker.
Channel Library	/channel_library.html	Pre-loaded interop channels (NIFOG/VTAC). Add custom agency channels.
Grid Square Calculator	/grid.html	Grid ↔ lat/lon · distance and bearing between two grids

PAGE	URL	NOTES
Radio Cheat Sheets	/cheatsheets.html	Phonetic alphabet, Q-codes, RST scale, ICS structure, HF frequencies
ICS Position Checklists	/position_checklists.html	NIMS activation checklists for all ICS positions
Meeting Scheduler	/meetings.html	Schedule operational briefings — time, location, attendees
Print Center	/printcenter.html	Print any ICS form or document to any CUPS printer on EMCOMM-NET
Reference Library	/refs.html	Kiwix offline — WikiMed, Wikipedia, iFixit. No internet needed.
Health Monitor	:5051/health	Live CPU/memory/disk/temp, all service status, GPS, internet
Pat Winlink Client	:8090	Browser-based Winlink client (Packet, VARA HF, Telnet)
Kiwix Library	:8080/	Offline Wikipedia, WikiMed, iFixit, Wikivoyage

Service & Port Reference

All services run on the FieldCommand Pi (192.168.50.1) unless noted. The AMPRNet gateway runs on a separate Pi (192.168.50.2).

PORT	SERVICE	SYSTEMD UNIT	DESCRIPTION
80	nginx	nginx.service	Web frontend — all 49 HTML pages, static assets
5050	FCC Lookup Server	fieldcommand-fcc.service	FCC callsign lookup, org config, incidents, net logs
5051	ICS Platform	fieldcommand-main.service	ICS forms, T-cards, check-ins, FEMA costs, GPS, PAR
8080	Kiwix Library	kiwix.service	Offline reference — WikiMed, Wikipedia, iFixit
8090	Pat Winlink	pat.service	Winlink email-over-radio — Packet, VARA HF, VARA FM
631	CUPS Printer	cups.service	USB printer shared to all EMCOMM-NET devices
2442	JS8Call	(laptop app)	HF digital keyboard messaging — web API on Windows laptop
9000	AMPRNet Status	amprgate-status.service	AMPRNet gateway read-only status — public on EMCOMM-NET
9001	AMPRNet Control	amprgate-status.service	Tunnel control — localhost only on gateway Pi

Background Services

SYSTEMD UNIT	FUNCTION
fieldcommand-main.service	ICS platform server (port 5051) — T-cards, FEMA, PAR, GPS, check-in
fieldcommand-fcc.service	FCC lookup + org config server (port 5050)
wan-monitor.service	WAN source monitoring and automatic failover every 30 seconds
wan-monitor.timer	Timer that keeps wan-monitor running on schedule

SYSTEMD UNIT	FUNCTION
amprgate-status.service	44Net gateway status API (ports 9000/9001 on gateway Pi)
amprgate-poll.service	44Net WireGuard tunnel keepalive and reconnect on gateway Pi
backup.service / backup.timer	Nightly SQLite backup to labelled USB drive
kiwix.service	Kiwix offline reference library server (port 8080)
pat.service	Pat Winlink radio email client (port 8090)
nginx.service	Web frontend — serves all HTML pages and static assets (port 80)
cups.service	CUPS print server — shares USB printer to EMCOMM-NET

New Feature Configuration

FieldCommand IMS v1.0 includes the following features beyond the base ICS platform. Most require no additional setup — they are available immediately after installation. Items that require initial configuration are noted below.

Personnel Accountability (PAR)

The Personnel Accountability page (/accountability.html) is available immediately after installation. No additional setup is required. It reads from the same checkin_entries and tcard_personnel database tables that are created during normal installation.

FEATURE	SETUP REQUIRED
ICS-211 check-in with Check Out button	None — available at /checkin.html immediately
QR/barcode scan check-in	None — available at /scan_checkin.html. Camera permission required on device.
PAR board with cross-reference	None — available at /accountability.html immediately
T-card personnel roster	None — Personnel tab appears on every T-card detail panel
Check-out recording	None — Check Out button on every check-in row in checkin.html and accountability.html

FEMA PA Cost Documentation

FEMA cost tracking is available immediately. The 2025 FEMA Schedule of Equipment Rates (44 categories) is pre-loaded during installation. Update rates annually at /fema_rates.html when FEMA publishes a new schedule.

FEATURE	NOTES
Force Account Labor with fringe calculation	Available immediately. ICS-214 import available from the Labor tab.
Equipment with FEMA rate schedule lookup	44 rates pre-loaded for 2025. Edit at /fema_rates.html annually.
Materials and Contracts tracking	Available immediately. Source documentation required for FEMA PW.
Project Worksheet text export	Click Export PW Text on any incident for a formatted PW summary.
Real-time cost dashboard	Available at /cost_dashboard.html. Auto-refreshes every 2 minutes.

Pre-Planned Event Templates

Six built-in templates are pre-loaded during installation: Emergency Shelter Operations, Search and Rescue, Severe Weather Response, Mass Gathering, HazMat Response, and Exercise/Training Scenario. Templates can be edited and new ones created at /event_templates.html.

STEP	ACTION
1	Navigate to http://192.168.50.1/event_templates.html
2	Click the Activate tab — browse the template gallery
3	Click a template — enter incident name and any custom details
4	Click Activate Template — a new incident is created pre-loaded with objectives, resource types, channels, and ICS organization structure
5	To edit a template: click Manage Templates → Edit → modify Objectives, Resources, Channels, or Organization tabs → Save Template
6	Export as JSON to share with other FieldCommand systems: click Export JSON

GPS-Tracked Resource Map

The GPS resource map (/resource_map.html) displays color-coded pins for all resources that have a GPS position set. Three placement methods are available.

METHOD	HOW TO USE
Device GPS (browser)	Click Set Position on any resource → click  Use Device GPS. Browser requests location permission. Accuracy shown in meters.
Click map to place	Click  Click Map to Place → crosshair cursor appears → click anywhere on the map to drop the resource pin.
Manual coordinates	Type decimal lat/lon directly into the fields. Negative longitude for western hemisphere.

IAP Export — Print, PDF, and Off-Site Saving

FieldCommand provides three ways to output the IAP, covering both on-site printing and off-site/no-printer scenarios. All three are accessible from the IAP Assembly page ([iap.html](/iap.html)).

OPTION	HOW TO USE	BEST FOR
 Print IAP	iap.html → select period and forms → click Print IAP	Printer available on EMCOMM-NET or device
 Save as PDF (recommended)	iap.html → select period and forms → click Save as PDF. Pi server generates a proper 8.5×11 PDF. Downloads as .pdf file.	Off-site printing, emailing, archiving. Guaranteed correct layout. Copy to USB or email.
 Save as HTML (fallback)	iap.html → select period and forms → click Save as HTML. Browser generates HTML file directly — no server call.	Fallback if server unreachable. Open in any browser and use File → Print. Page layout may vary by browser.
 Full PDF Compiler	iap_compile.html → check forms → click Download IAP PDF (5–15 sec).	Full PDF with cover page, section dividers, embedded signatures. Best for the official distributable IAP package.

NEXRAD Animated Radar

The radar page (</radar.html>) requires an active internet connection for radar tile loading. When offline, it displays the last loaded frame with a timestamp. No installation configuration is required — it pulls tiles from NWS RIDGE II directly.

The radar page auto-detects WAN status and resumes loading new tiles automatically when internet connectivity is restored. No manual action is required after a WAN outage.

Dual-Source WAN Configuration

FieldCommand IMS supports two simultaneous WAN sources with automatic failover. Configure both sources at /wan_settings.html after installation.

FIELD	OPTIONS & DESCRIPTION
Role	Preferred (used first) · Fallback (used when preferred fails)
Type	Cellular · Satellite · Hotspot · Fixed broadband · Other
Detection method	internet_only — any internet path works (best for hotspots and USB dongles) ping — checks a specific gateway IP admin_reachable — checks modem admin interface URL
Label	Human-readable name shown on dashboard: "Cellular", "Satellite", etc.
Enabled	Toggle a source on or off without deleting configuration

STEP	ACTION
1	Navigate to http://192.168.50.1/wan_settings.html
2	Click + Add WAN Source to add a source, or click Edit on an existing one
3	Set Role to Preferred for your primary source (e.g. cellular antenna)
4	Set Role to Fallback for your secondary source (e.g. satellite dish)
5	Choose the Detection Method appropriate for each source type
6	Click Save. The WAN monitor applies the new configuration within 60 seconds.
7	Use ■ Swap Roles to swap preferred and fallback without editing.

Digital Signature Capture

All 16 Prepared By and Approved By signature fields across the ICS form set support digital signature capture. Signatures are stored as PNG images in the database and are embedded in printed forms and compiled IAP PDFs. No setup required.

To sign: click any Prepared By or Approved By field → signature pad appears → sign with mouse, touchscreen, or stylus → click Accept. Signatures persist through page reloads and appear in the IAP PDF compilation.

Incident Archive and Beta Reset

FUNCTION	HOW TO USE	NOTES
Archive to USB	incident_mgmt.html → select incident → Archive to USB	USB drive must be labelled FIELDCOMMAND. JSON written to <code>/media/fieldcommand/backup/incidents/</code>
Restore from USB	incident_mgmt.html → Restore from USB → select JSON file	Restores incident to fully active status with all forms, T-cards, costs, and check-ins
Hard delete from Pi	incident_mgmt.html → select archived incident → Hard Delete	Permanent — confirm archive exists on USB before deleting
Beta/Scenario Reset	incident_mgmt.html → Beta/Scenario Reset → Confirm	Wipes all incidents, forms, T-cards, costs, check-ins. Preserves roster, channels, repeaters.

The USB drive must have volume label FIELDCOMMAND (all capitals). Format as FAT32 or exFAT. Label with: `sudo mlabel -i /dev/sdX1 ::FIELDCOMMAND` (replace sdX1 with actual USB device).

Maintenance & Updates

```
# Interactive maintenance menu:
sudo bash /opt/fieldcommand/scripts/update.sh

# Menu options:
# 1) Restart all services
# 2) Stop all services
# 3) Check service status
# 4) View live logs
# 5) Refresh FCC database
# 6) Fetch repeater data
# 7) Update web files from current directory
# 8) Backup data to /tmp
# 9) Show disk usage
```

Loading Repeater Data

The Repeater Database is populated by the Net Control operator or technical lead before each activation. No API token is required for the recommended method.

STEP	ACTION
1	On any device connected to EMCOMM-NET, open a browser and go to http://192.168.50.1/repeaters.html .
2	Click the Offline File tab (active by default).
3	From a device with internet access, log in at repeaterbook.com (free account) → search your county and surrounding mutual-aid area → click Export → CSV .
4	Transfer the CSV to a device on EMCOMM-NET (email it to yourself, copy to USB, or download on a device already on EMCOMM-NET).
5	Drag the CSV file onto the drop zone, or click to browse and select it.
6	Repeaters load instantly and are saved to the local database — they persist through reboots and are immediately available in the ICS-205 channel picker, channel library, and cheat sheets.

The CSV export from repeaterbook.com requires only a free account login — it is not the same as the RepeaterBook API token. The API token is a separate application process (repeaterbook.com/api/token_request.php) and is only needed if you want the Pi to fetch data automatically via `fetch_repeater.py`. For most deployments, refreshing the CSV before each activation is the practical approach.

USB Auto-Backup

Insert a USB drive formatted with the label **FIELDCOMMAND** to trigger an automatic backup of all runtime data. The backup copies `/opt/fieldcommand/data/` to a timestamped folder on the USB drive.

```
# Format a USB drive with label FIELDCOMMAND (Linux):
sudo mkfs.vfat -n FIELDCOMMAND /dev/sda1

# Or on Windows: format as FAT32, set volume label to FIELDCOMMAND

# Backup destination on USB:
# /media/fieldcommand/backup/YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS
```

Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE / FIX
http://192.168.50.1 not reachable	Pi not running, or ASUS router not configured with 192.168.50.x subnet. Check Pi power LED. Verify router LAN IP is 192.168.50.1.
Dashboard loads but cards give errors	Not connected to EMCOMM-NET — device is on a different network. Check Wi-Fi — must show EMCOMM-NET.
FCC lookup returns no results	FCC database not yet built. Run: <code>sudo systemctl start fcc-refresh.service</code> (needs internet)
Repeater database is empty	No repeater data loaded yet. On any EMCOMM-NET device, open repeaters.html → Offline File tab → download a CSV from repeaterbook.com (free account, no API token needed) → drag the CSV onto the drop zone.
APRS map shows no stations	Direwolf or YAAC not running, or no RF received yet. Check Health Monitor for service status. Confirm antenna connected.
Winlink form import fails	Wrong file type — must be the XML attachment, not the message body. In Winlink Express, right-click .xml attachment → Save As → then import.
Service dot is red on Health Monitor	Background service has stopped. SSH to Pi: <code>sudo systemctl restart</code>
Pat Winlink not accessible at port 8090	pat.service not running. Run: <code>sudo systemctl start pat</code> && <code>sudo systemctl enable pat</code>
JS8Call card does not open	TCP Server API not enabled in JS8Call, or wrong IP entered. Verify: File → Settings → Reporting → Enable TCP Server API, port 2442, hostname 0.0.0.0.
Printer not visible on EMCOMM-NET	avahi-daemon not running, or CUPS printer not shared. Check: <code>sudo systemctl status avahi-daemon cups</code> . Verify Share This Printer is checked in CUPS UI.
Issue: Services crash on startup	Low disk space or permission error. Check: <code>df -h /</code> and <code>ls -la /opt/fieldcommand/</code> . Verify fieldcommand user owns /opt/fieldcommand/.

■ For any issue not covered here — open the Health Monitor at <http://192.168.50.1:5051/health> or check the system log with: `journalctl -u fcc-lookup -n 50`

Quick Reference Card

ITEM	VALUE
FieldCommand dashboard	<code>http://192.168.50.1</code>
Wi-Fi network (SSID)	EMCOMM-NET
WAN status dashboard	<code>http://192.168.50.1/wan-status.html</code>
FieldCommand Pi static IP	192.168.50.1
Cellular modem admin	See your cellular modem documentation for the admin URL (often 192.168.1.1 or 10.0.0.1)
WAN data plan	Manage via your cellular carrier or satellite provider portal
Satellite dish admin	See your satellite dish documentation for the admin URL
44Net Gateway Pi IP	192.168.50.2
44Net gateway status	<code>http://192.168.50.2:9000</code>
AMPRNet tunnel check	ping 44.0.0.1 (from any EMMCOMM-NET device)
ASUS router admin	<code>http://192.168.50.254</code>
CUPS printer admin	<code>http://192.168.50.1:631</code>
Pat Winlink (backup)	<code>http://192.168.50.1:8090</code>
Kiwix offline library	<code>http://192.168.50.1:8081</code>
Health monitor (raw)	<code>http://192.168.50.1:5051/health</code>
JS8Call TCP API (laptop)	<code>http://[laptop-ip]:2442</code>
Your callsign	your organization
your county grid	
Default coordinates	your deployment coordinates (decimal degrees)
Install log	<code>/var/log/fieldcommand-install.log</code>
Application data	<code>/opt/fieldcommand/data/</code>
HTML pages	<code>/opt/fieldcommand/html/</code>
Update script	<code>sudo bash /opt/fieldcommand/scripts/update.sh</code>